4.

Customer Engagement & Social Media



Dr. Carmen Lopez

Module Structure

Week No.	Lecture Topic
1	Introduction: Traditional Marketing vs Digital Marketing
2	Marketing Environment in the Digital Age
3	Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning in the Digital Age
4	Customer Engagement and Social Media
5	Content Marketing and Influencer Marketing
6	Consumer Behaviour and Customer Insight in the Digital Age
7	Search Marketing and Online Advertising
8	Email Marketing and Digital Customer Relationship Management
9	Online PR and Crisis Management
10	Marketing Research in the Digital Age
11	Ethics & The Future of Digital Marketing
12	Discussion Forum. Assignment Q&A

Why is this lecture relevant?



Structure for the assignment:

Title page

Introduction

A brief introduction to Popcorn Kitchen and the relevant UK industry.

(Roughly 300 words)

Digital challenges and opportunities

Overview of two key challenges and two key opportunities that Popcorn Kitchen faces in the digital age.

(Roughly 400 words)

Target market & Customer persona profile

Identify and justify the segment to target (e.g., demographics, behaviours, attitudes, motivations, brands, etc.). Based on this segment, create a persona profile (visual format) for Popcorn Kitchen in the UK. The persona profile should reflect an existing segment and be based on research. Justify your choices.

(Roughly 500 words)

Customer engagement: Conceptualisation and evaluation of strategies

Define customer engagement and its dimensions. Considering the customer persona, evaluate Popcorn Kitchen's digital marketing strategies (e.g., content development strategy, customer experience strategy, social media strategies, etc.) used in the UK to engage with customers in light of the digital customer literature. Practical observations and examples of Popcorn Kitchen's customer engagement should be used to justify the arguments.

(Roughly 1200 words)

Recommendations

Considering the existing literature/theories, and the customer engagement strategies discussed in the previous section, suggest recommendations for the business to enhance customer engagement. Recommendations should be realistic and suitable for implementation over the next 6-12 months and should reflect informed judgement rather than a descriptive list of digital tools or tactics. Be creative and justify your recommendations.

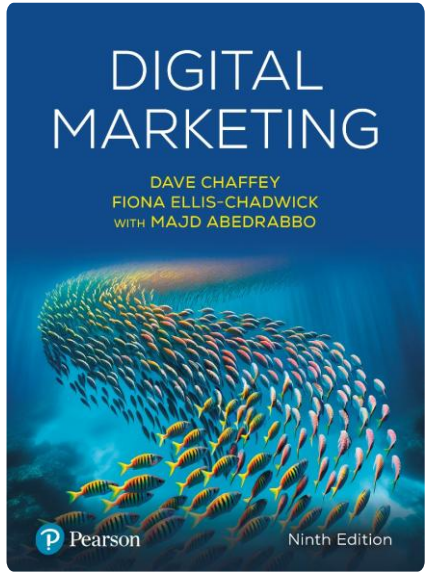
(Roughly 600 words)

References

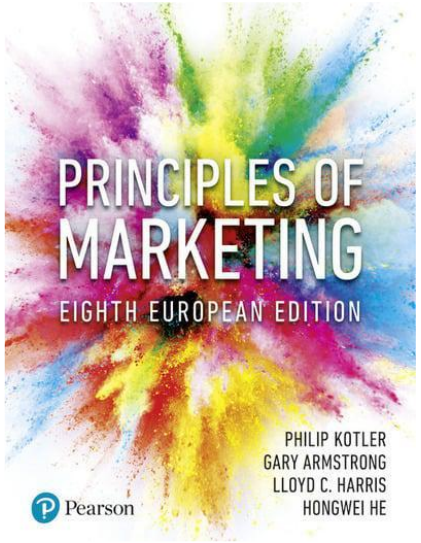
Appendix

Recommended Reading

Chapters 6, 9



Chapters 14, 17



Agenda

- Relationship marketing
- Consumer brand engagement
  - Definition
  - Dimensions
  - Antecedents, consequences
- Social media
- Engagement behaviors on social media
- Engagement strategies

Relationship Marketing

A Shift in Marketing Perspective

Traditional  Modern



Transactional

Transaction focus

Maximisation of immediate profits

Short-term goals

Product-centric

Loyalty as a secondary outcome

Relational

Relationship focused

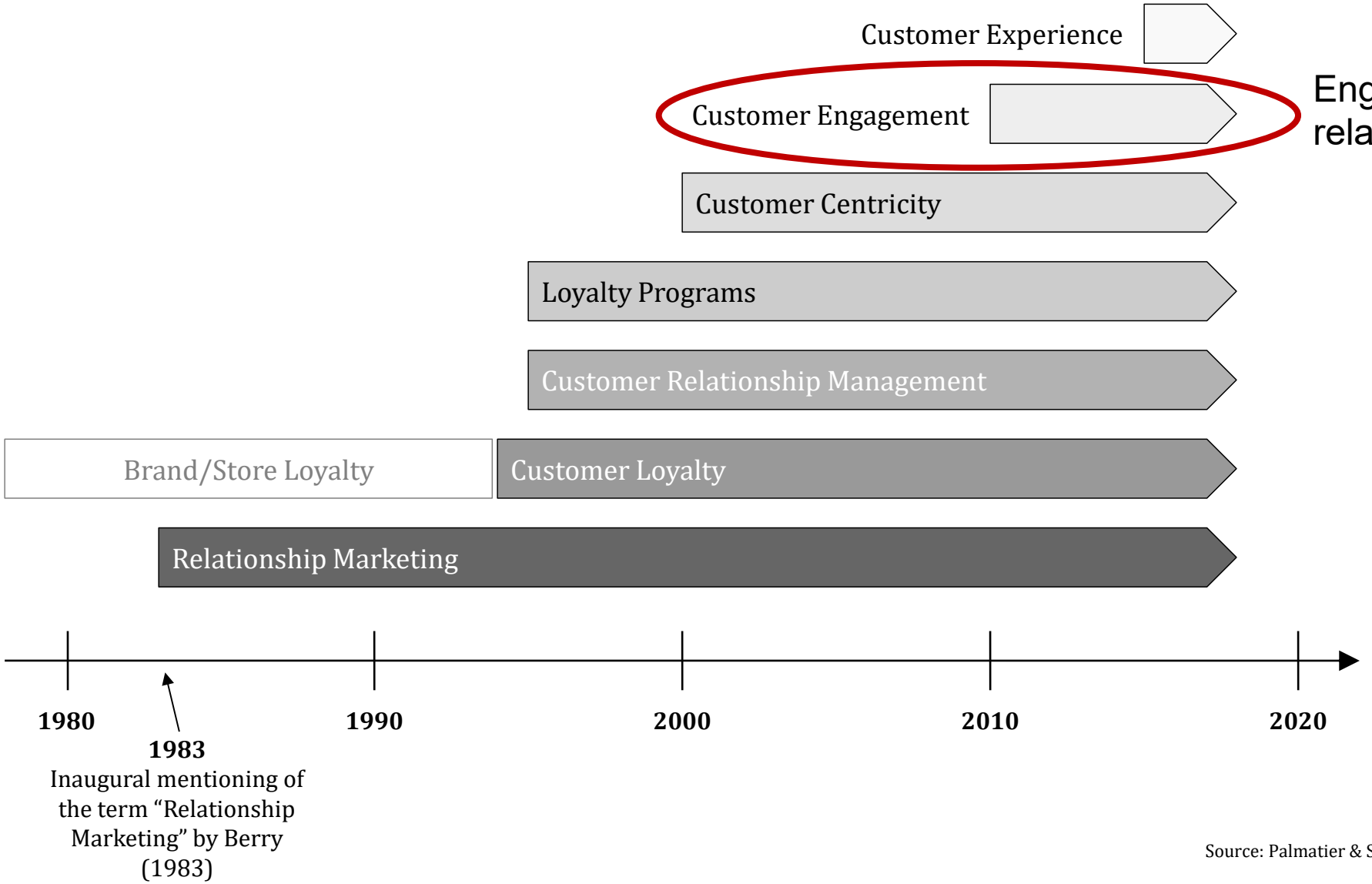
Maximisation of customer lifetime value

Long-term strategy

Customer-centric

Transaction as a secondary outcome

Evolution of Relationship Marketing Terminology



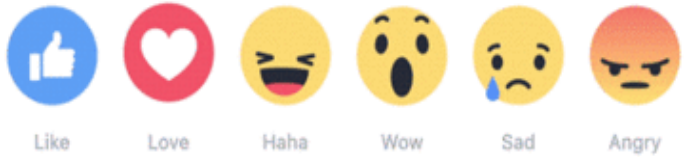
Source: Palmatier & Steinhoff (2019, p. 14)

Understanding Consumer Brand Engagement

Consumer brand engagement

Engagement is a relational construct that reflects the **interactive** nature of the **consumer–brand relationship** (Hollebeek et al., 2014).

"A **multidimensional** concept comprising cognitive, emotional, and/or behavioral dimensions, [which] plays a central role in the process of relational exchange where other relational concepts are engagement antecedents and/or consequences in iterative engagement processes within the brand community" (Brodie et al., 2013, p. 107).





Additional Engagement Conceptualisations

Customer brand engagement refers to "the level of an individual customer's motivational, brand-related and context-dependent state of mind characterised by specific levels of cognitive, emotional and behavioral activity in brand interactions" (Hollebeek, 2011a).

Customer engagement refers to "a motivational state that occurs by virtue of interactive, co-creative customer experiences with a focal agent/object (e.g. a brand) in focal brand relationships" (Brodie et al., 2011).

Consumer engagement refers to the "intensity of an individual's participation and connection with the organization's offerings and activities initiated by either the customer or the organization." (Vivek et al., 2014).

Consumer brand engagement refers to "a consumer's positively valenced cognitive, emotional and behavioral brand-related activity during, or related to, specific consumer/brand interactions" (Hollebeek, 2014).



Consumer brand engagement (CBE)

"**A multidimensional concept comprising cognitive, emotional, and/or behavioral dimensions**, [which] plays a central role in the process of relational exchange where other relational concepts are engagement antecedents and/or consequences in iterative engagement processes within the brand community." (Brodie et al., 2013, p. 107)

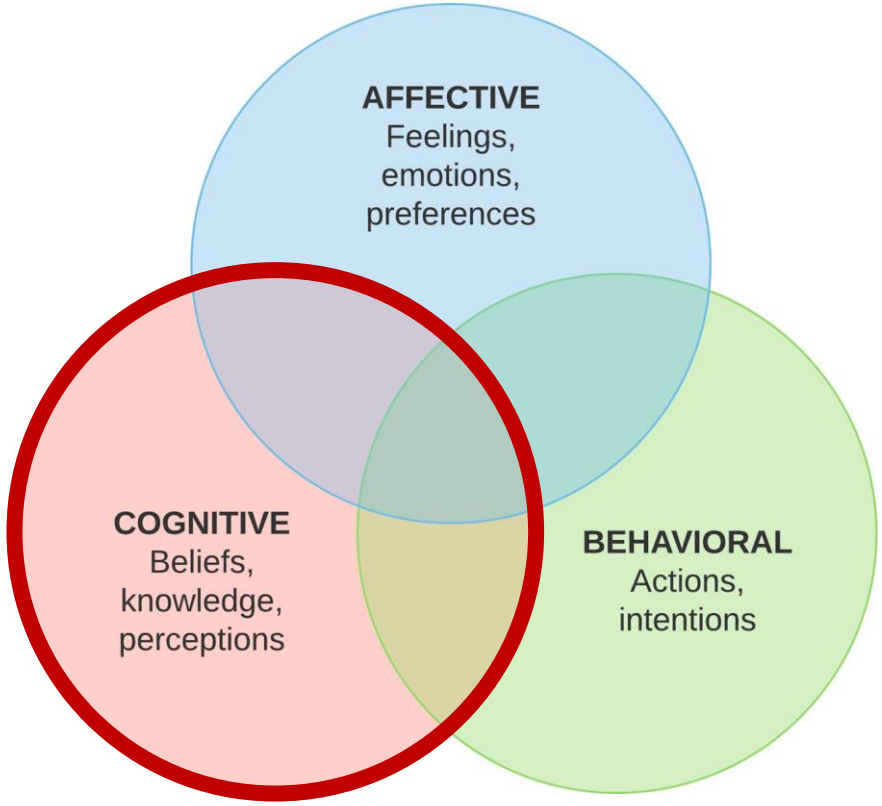
Multidimensional: cognition, affect, and behaviour

The COGNITIVE dimension of CBE

Cognition: The process of acquiring knowledge and understanding through thought, experience, and senses.

With respect to consumer brand engagement…

- Brand information processing
- Actively considering the brand
- Positively comparing the brand to other competitors



Cognitive

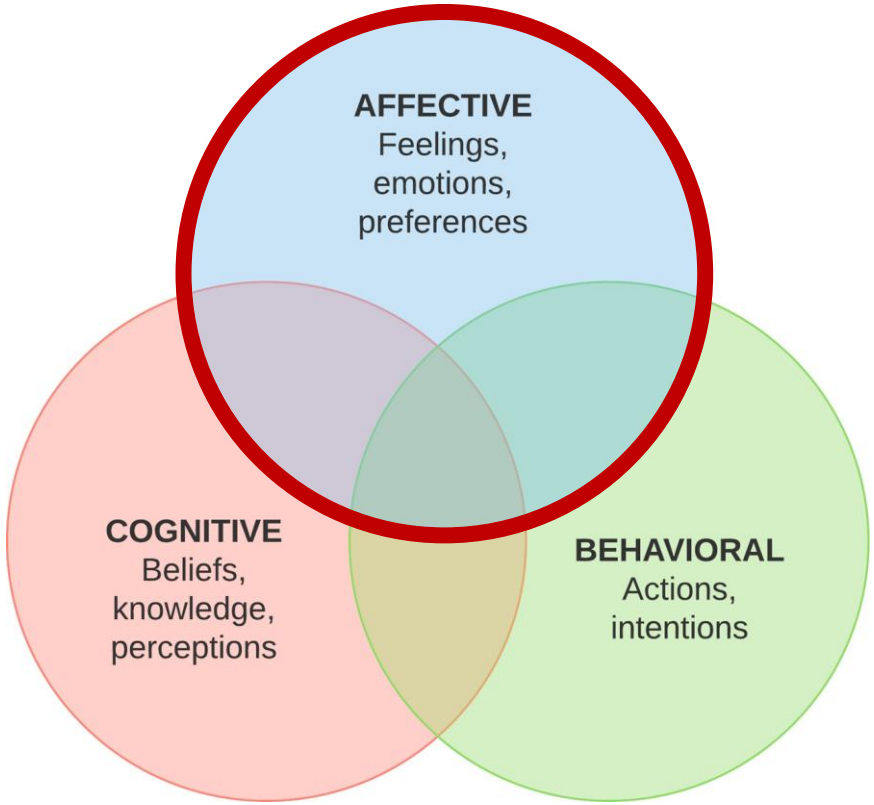
"I consider the information of this brand to be useful."

The AFFECTVE dimension of CBE

Affect: A consumer's degree of subjective emotion or feelings. It refers specifically to how we feel about a focal object.

With respect to brand engagement…

- Feelings about a brand
- Customer experience
- Emotional outcomes of brand interactions



Affective

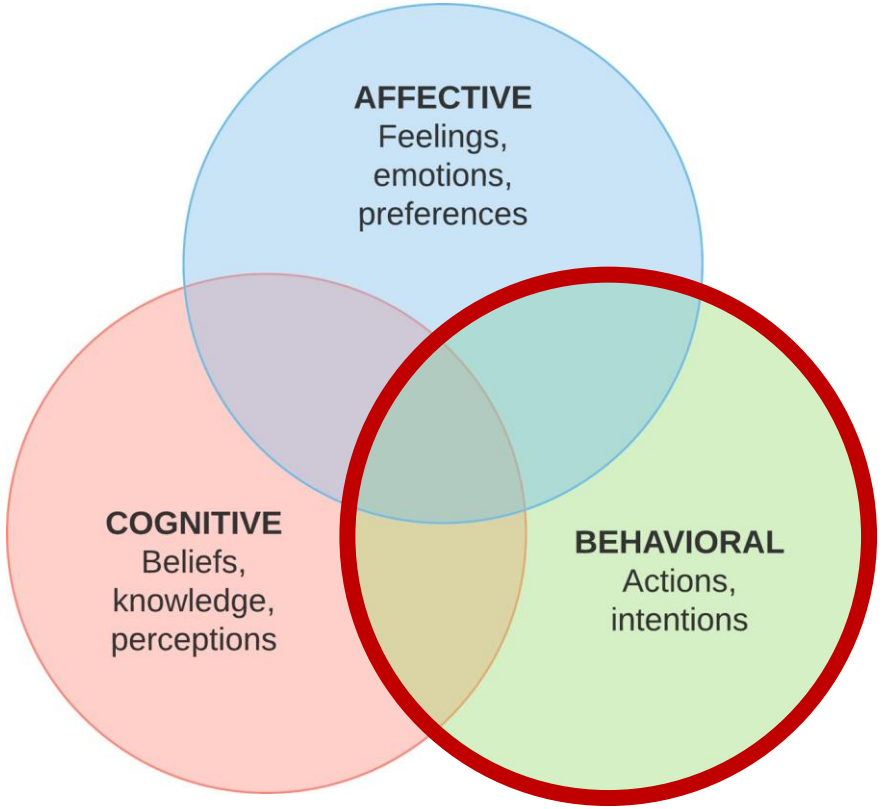
"Interacting with the brand makes me feel good about myself."

The BEHAVIOURAL dimension of CBE

Behaviour: The way individuals respond to stimuli/events in an environment.

With respect to brand engagement…

- How we actively behave in brand interactions
- Also encompasses intentions (i.e. how we plan to act)



Behavioural

"I wouldn't miss (brand name's) online event for the world!"

Consumer brand engagement (CBE)

"A multidimensional concept comprising cognitive, emotional, and/or behavioral dimensions, [which] plays a central role in the process of relational exchange where other relational concepts are engagement **antecedents and/or consequences in iterative engagement processes within the brand community**." (Brodie et al., 2013, p. 107)

The engagement process includes engagement antecedents and/or consequences.

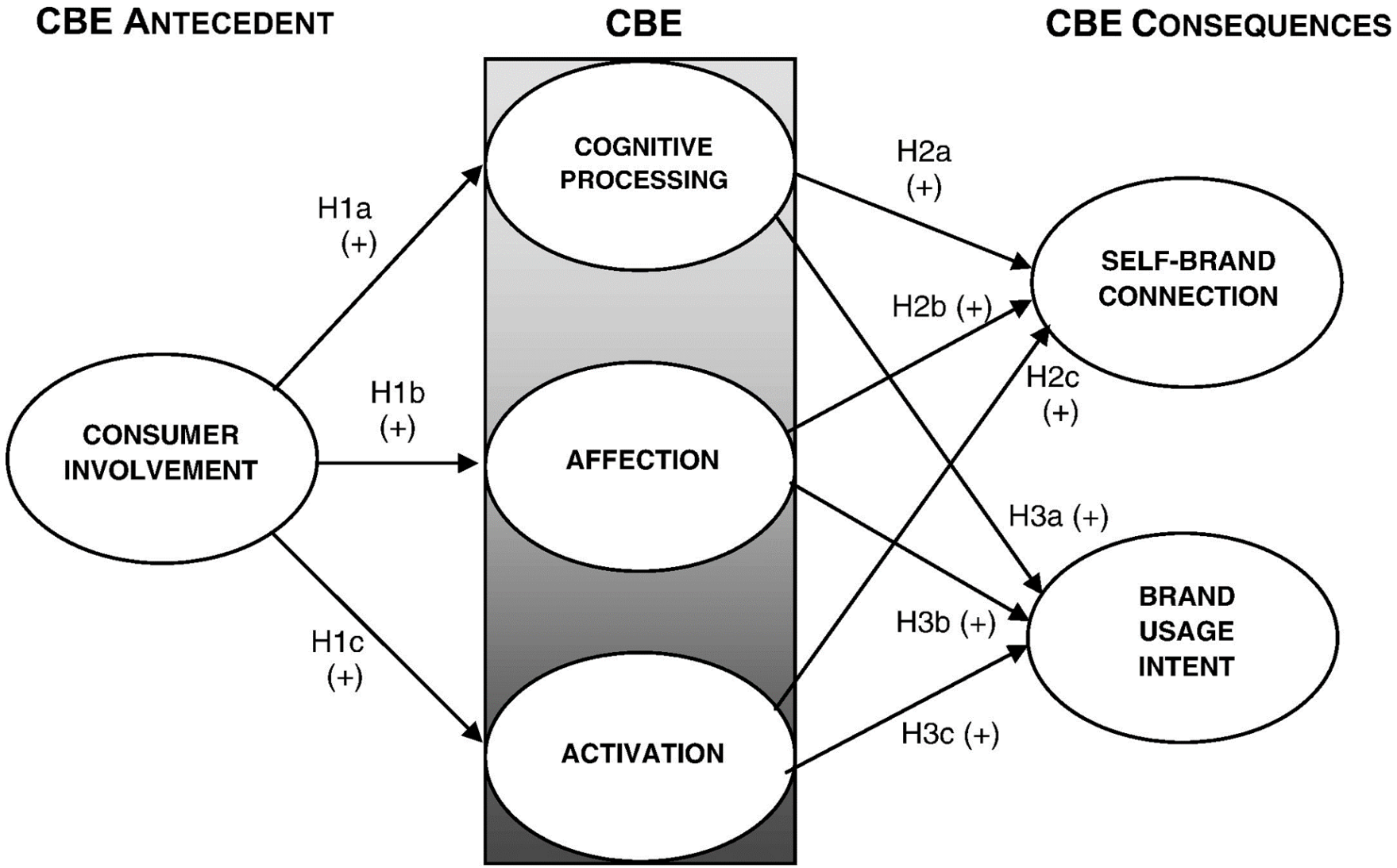
Why is CBE important?

Indicator of the strength of a company's customer relationship

Influence on consumer behaviour

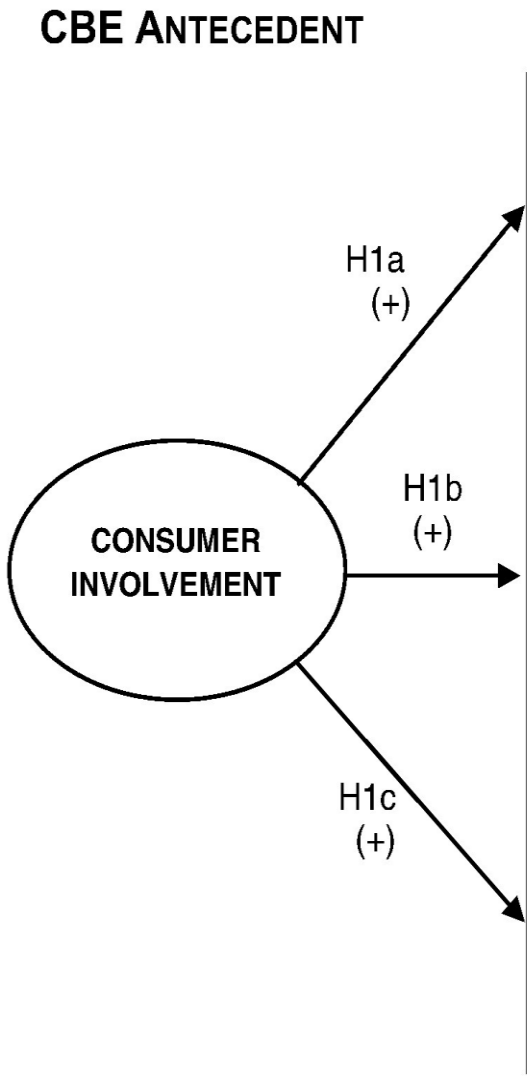
Impact on corporate performance (sales, profits, competitive advantages, product development, etc.)

Consumer engagement process



Source: Hollebeek, L.D., Glynn, M.S. and Brodie, R.J., 2014. Consumer brand engagement in social media: Conceptualization, scale development and validation. *Journal of interactive marketing*, *28*(2), pp.149-165.

Antecedents of CBE



What is the involvement construct?

- A psychological state.
- Determined by the relevance of focal object in relation to needs, values, and self-concept.
- An antecedent of CBE.

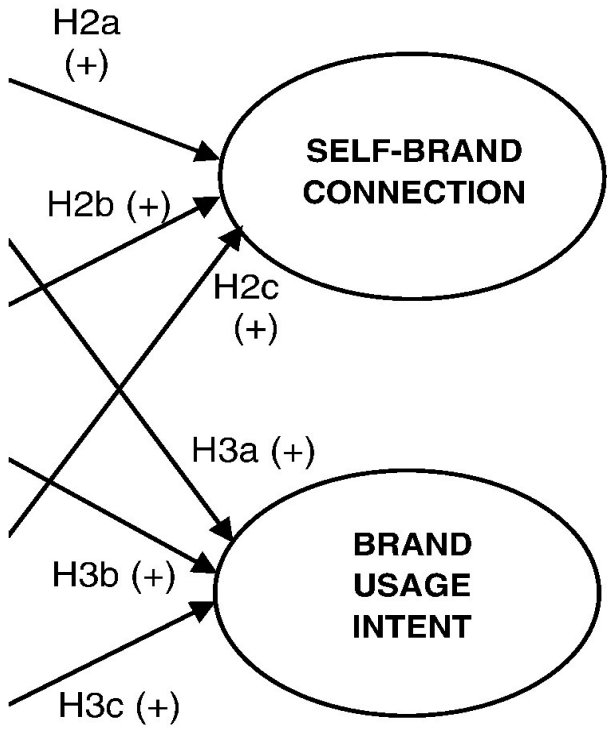
→ The greater involvement you hold, the more important it is to you.

Source: Hollebeek, L.D., Glynn, M.S. and Brodie, R.J., 2014. Consumer brand engagement in social media: Conceptualization, scale development and validation. *Journal of interactive marketing*, *28*(2), pp.149-165.

Consequences of CBE

Self-Brand Connection

- The degree to which a consumer identifies with a brand and incorporates it into their self-concept, influencing their behavior and brand loyalty.



Source: Hollebeek, L.D., Glynn, M.S. and Brodie, R.J., 2014. Consumer brand engagement in social media: Conceptualization, scale development and validation. *Journal of interactive marketing*, *28*(2), pp.149-165.

Consequences of CBE

Self-Brand Connection

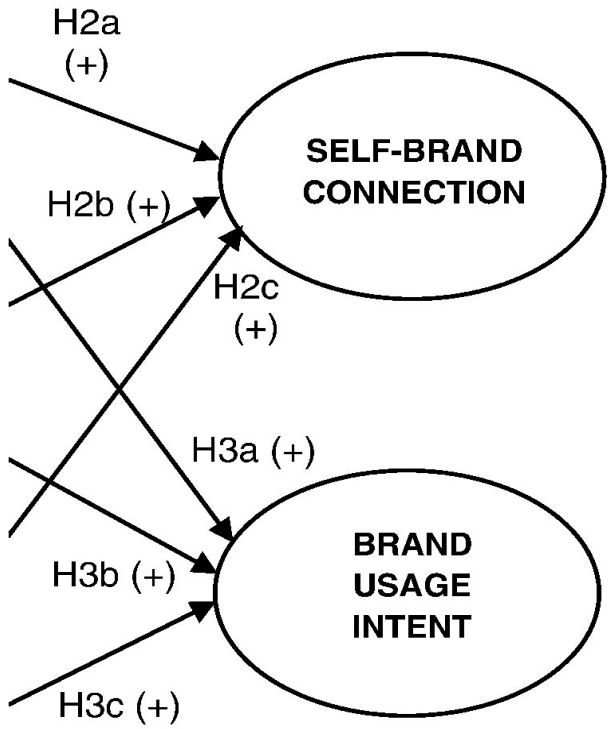
- The degree to which a consumer identifies with a brand and incorporates it into their self-concept, influencing their behavior and brand loyalty.

Brand Usage Intent

- The intention of a consumer to purchase or use a particular brand's products or services in the future.

…Increases in self-brand connection & brand usage intentions both signify **Brand Loyalty.**

CBE CONSEQUENCES



Source: Hollebeek, L.D., Glynn, M.S. and Brodie, R.J., 2014. Consumer brand engagement in social media: Conceptualization, scale development and validation. *Journal of interactive marketing*, *28*(2), pp.149-165.

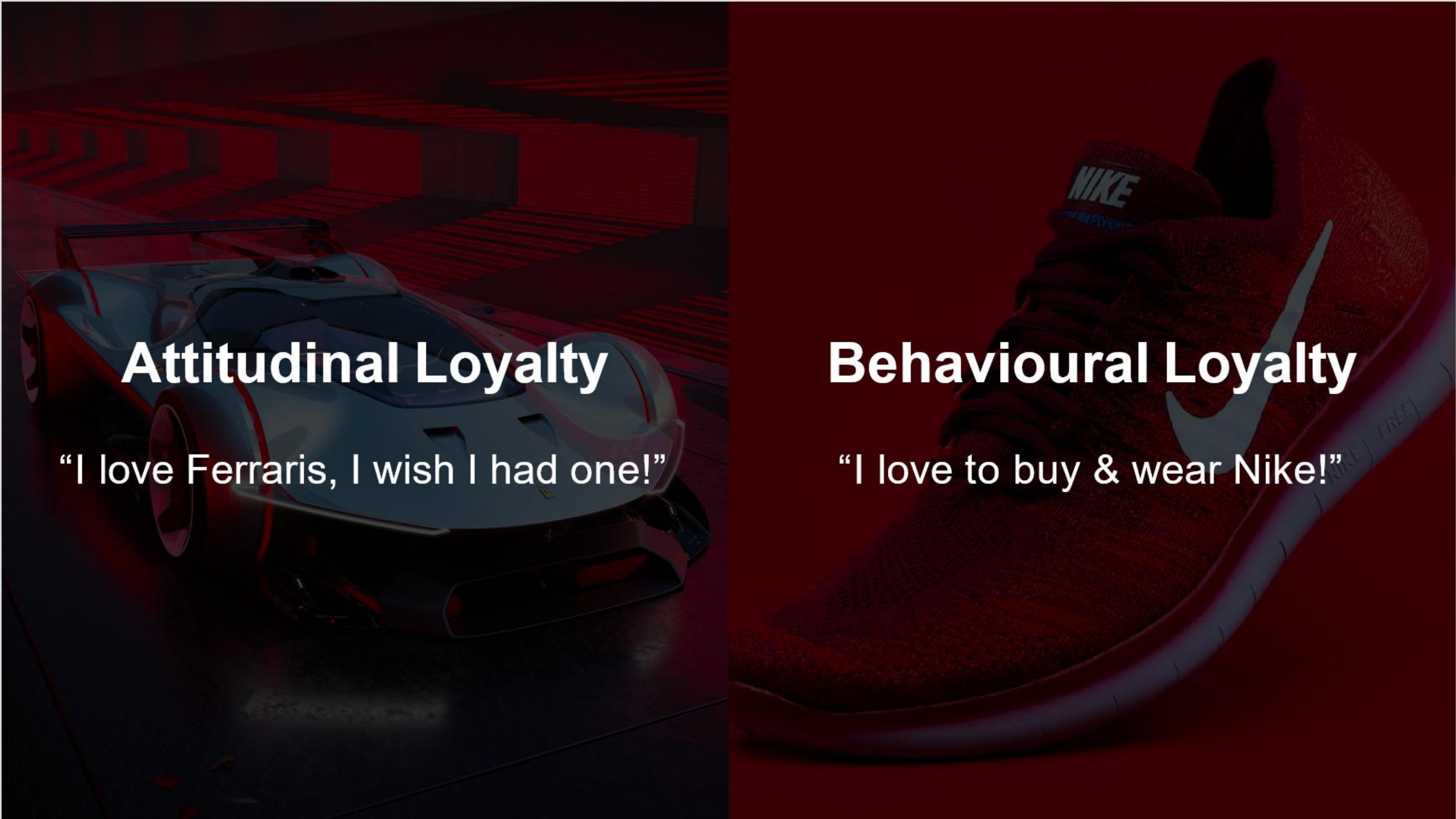
Brand Loyalty is a consumer's level of attachment to a brand.

It is generally developed through repeated positive interactions with a brand and/or its products/services.

Loyalty can be behavioural, affective, or both.




NIKE
NIKE
FREE



Attitudinal Loyalty

"I love Ferraris, I wish I had one!"

Behavioural Loyalty

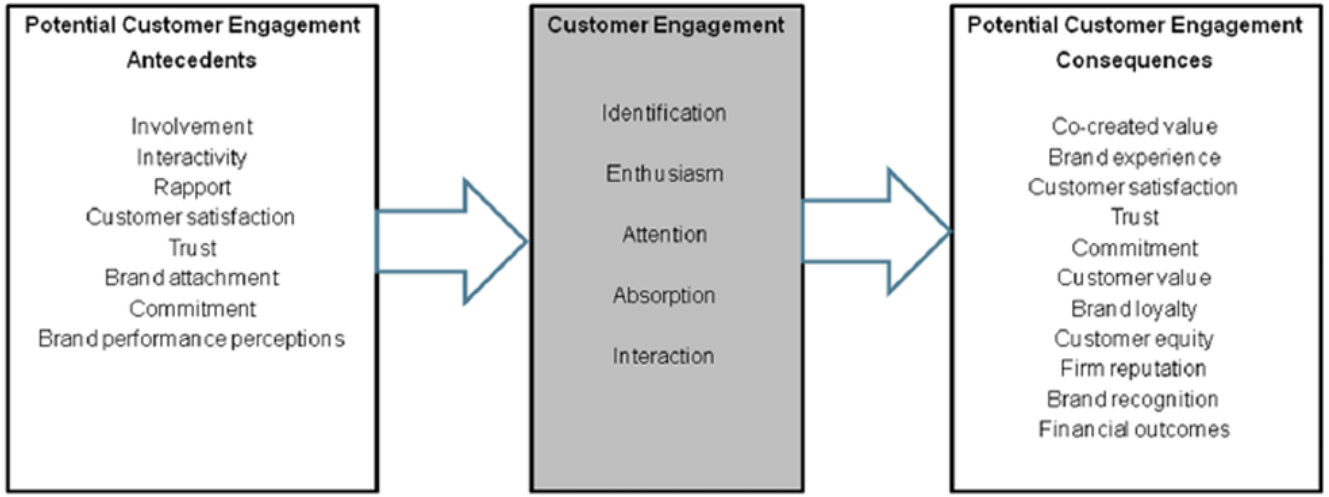
"I love to buy & wear Nike!"

The Benefits of Brand Loyalty

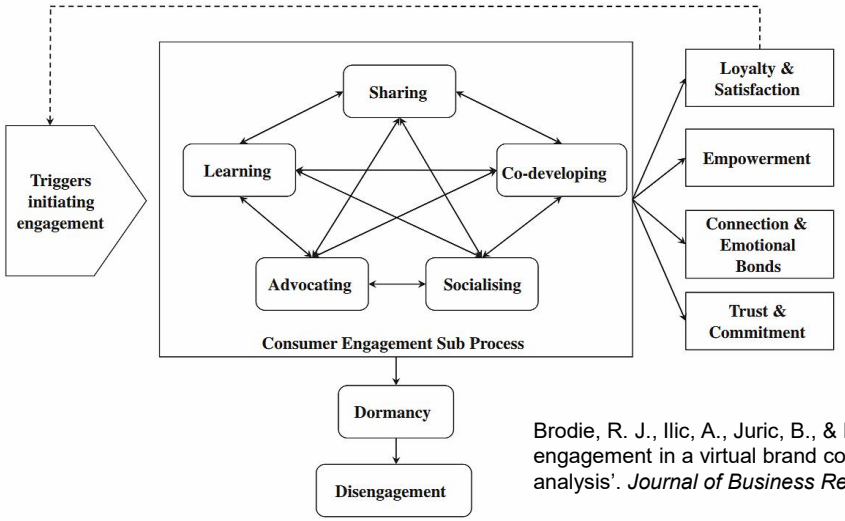
- ↑ Customer Lifetime Value
- ↑ Customer Retention
- ↑ Brand Advocacy
- ↓ Switching Behaviour

Source: Bain & Company (2006)

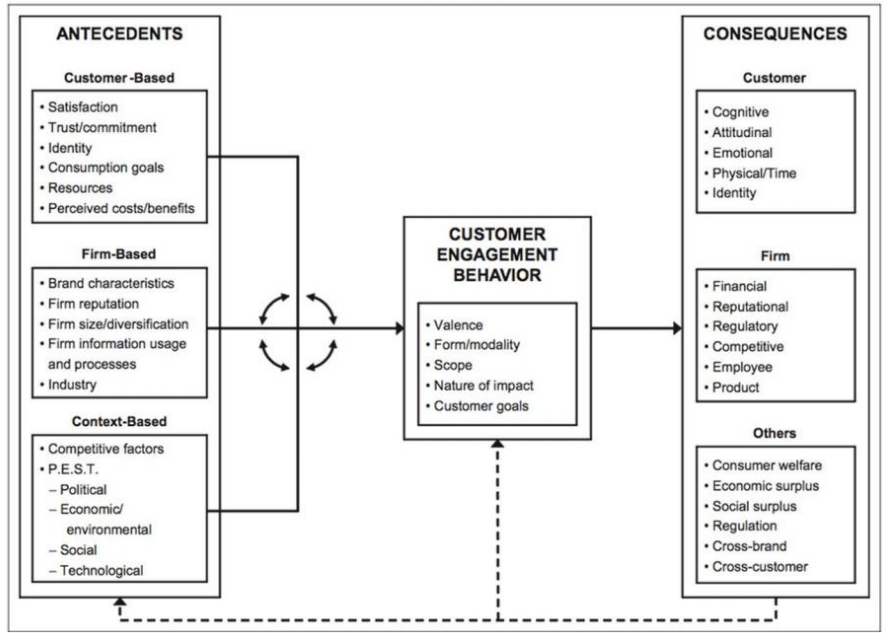
Additional Engagement Models that Include Antecedents and Consequences



So, K. K. F., King, C., & Sparks, B. (2014). Customer engagement with tourism brands: Scale development and validation. Journal of Hospitality & Tourism Research, 38(3), 304–329.



Brodie, R. J., Ilic, A., Juric, B., & Hollebeek, L. (2013) 'Consumer engagement in a virtual brand community: An exploratory analysis'. *Journal of Business Research*, *66*(1), 105-114.



Van Doorn, J., Lemon, K. N., Mittal, V., Nass, S., Pick, D., Pirner, P., & Verhoef, P. C. (2010) 'Customer engagement behavior: Theoretical foundations and research directions'. *Journal of Service Research*, *13*(3), 253-266.

Understanding Social Media

What is social media?

Social media is a “group of internet-based applications that build on the ideological and technological foundations of Web 2.0, and that allow the creation and exchange of user-generated content” (Kaplan and Haenlein, 2010, p. 61).

"Any online resource that is designed to facilitate engagement between individuals.” (Bishop, 2019, p. 61)

“computer-mediated communication software that enables users to create, share and view content in publicly networked one-to-one, one-to-many, and/or many-to-many communications.” (Hopkins, 2017)



Social media – Channel types

Typology	Main Theme(s)	Examples
Traditional Social Networks	Socialisation with friends and family, networking	X (Twitter), Facebook
Professional Social Networks	Connection with professionals, sharing knowledge, finding jobs	LinkedIn, Xing
Public Communities	Discussion open to anyone to join and participate in	Reddit, Quora
Private Communities	Discussion closed and requires invitation or approval to join	Slack, Discord
Chat-based Networks	Real-time communication between users	Whatsapp, WeChat
Media-sharing Networks	Sharing of photos and videos with a variety of users	Instagram, TikTok, YouTube
Blogging Networks	Dissemination of blog posts	WordPress, Tumblr, Medium
Consumer Review Networks	Reviewing & feedback of brand activities	Yelp, TripAdvisor

Types of Communication on Social Media

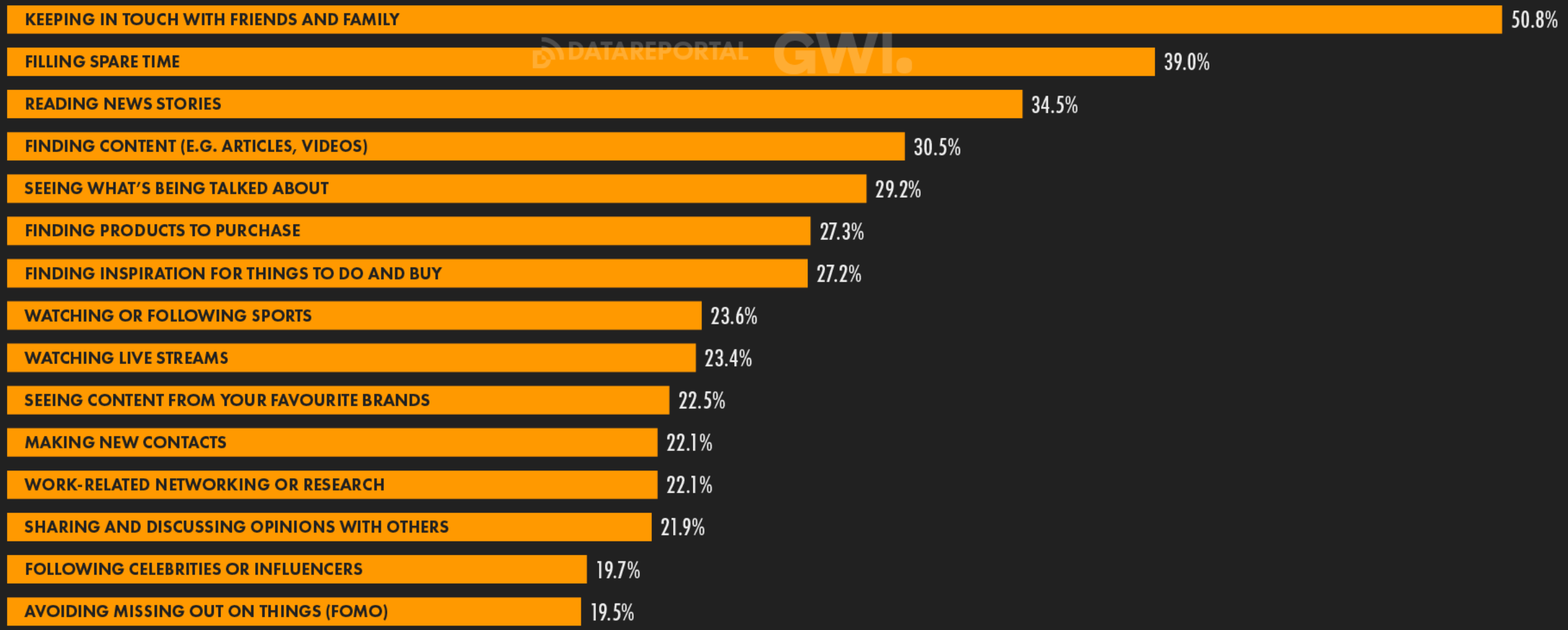
Typology	Definition	Examples
One-to-one	One individual communicating directly with another individual	Direct messaging, video calling, replying to stories.
One-to-many	One individual sends a message to a group of people	Blogs, public posts, sharing stories
Many-to-many	Multiple individuals all sending and receiving messages.	Group chats, forums, social media threads

FEB 2025

MAIN REASONS FOR USING SOCIAL MEDIA

PRIMARY REASONS WHY SOCIAL MEDIA USERS AGED 16+ USE SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS

GLOBAL OVERVIEW



DATAREPORTAL GWI.

SOURCE: GWI (Q3 2024). NOTE: FIGURES REPRESENT THE SHARE OF INTERNET USERS AGED 16+ WHO REPORT USING AT LEAST ONE SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORM OR MESSENGER SERVICE IN THE PAST MONTH.
COMPARABILITY: CHANGES IN AUDIENCE COMPOSITION AND SURVEY METHODOLOGY. SEE NOTES ON DATA.

we are social Meltwater

Social media facilitates engagement

Social media is characterised as being interactive and participative.

Social media is a direct channel between brands and consumers.

Social media fosters a sense of community around brands.

Social media provides users the ability to directly interact with brand-related activities.

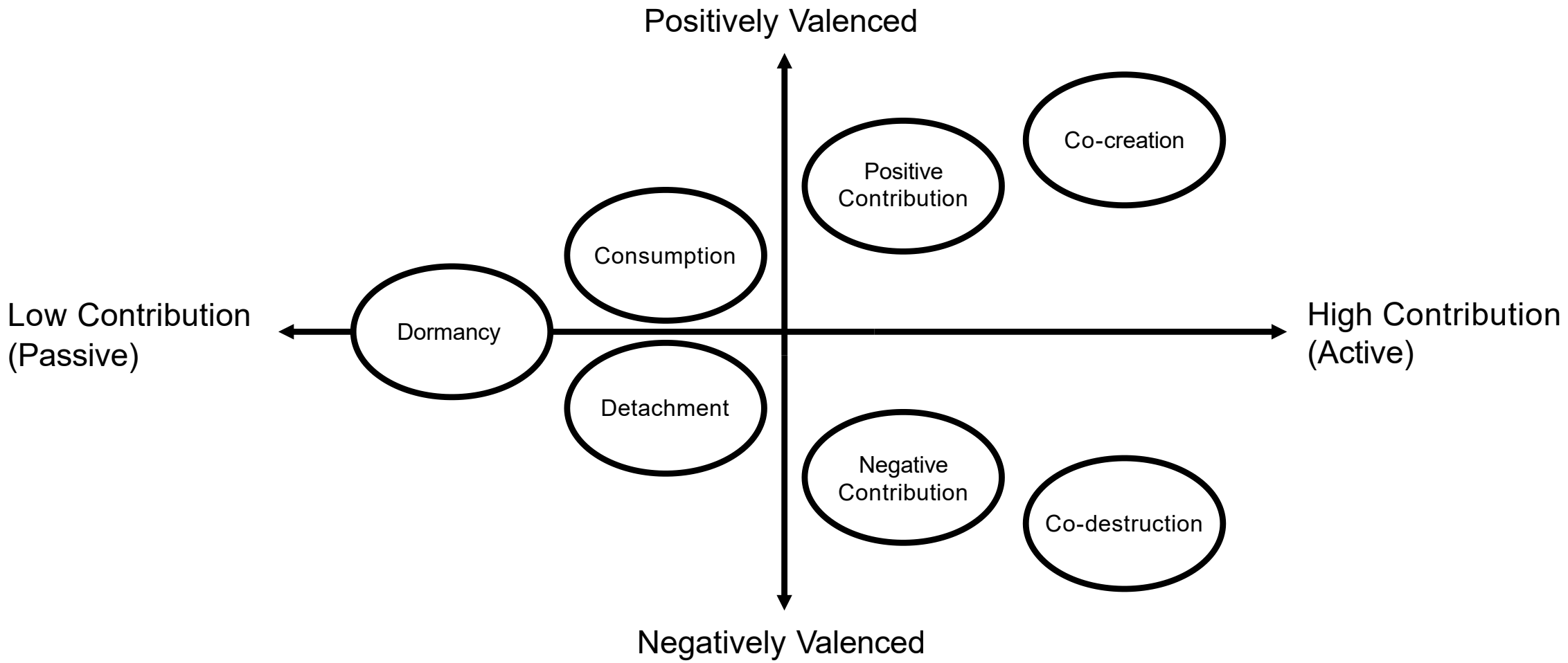
Social media is an essential channel for facilitating consumer brand engagement.

Source: Kaplan and Haenlein (2010); Mangold and Faulds (2009)

Social Media & Consumer Engagement

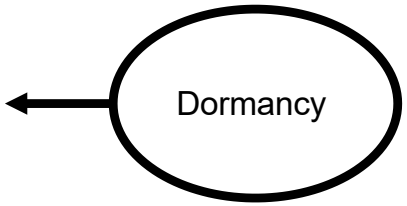
Social media engagement

A valence-based typology of how consumers engage.



Source: Dolan (2016)

Low Contribution (Passive)



Dormancy

A temporary state of inactive, passive SM engagement behaviour by users who have previously interacted with a specific community.

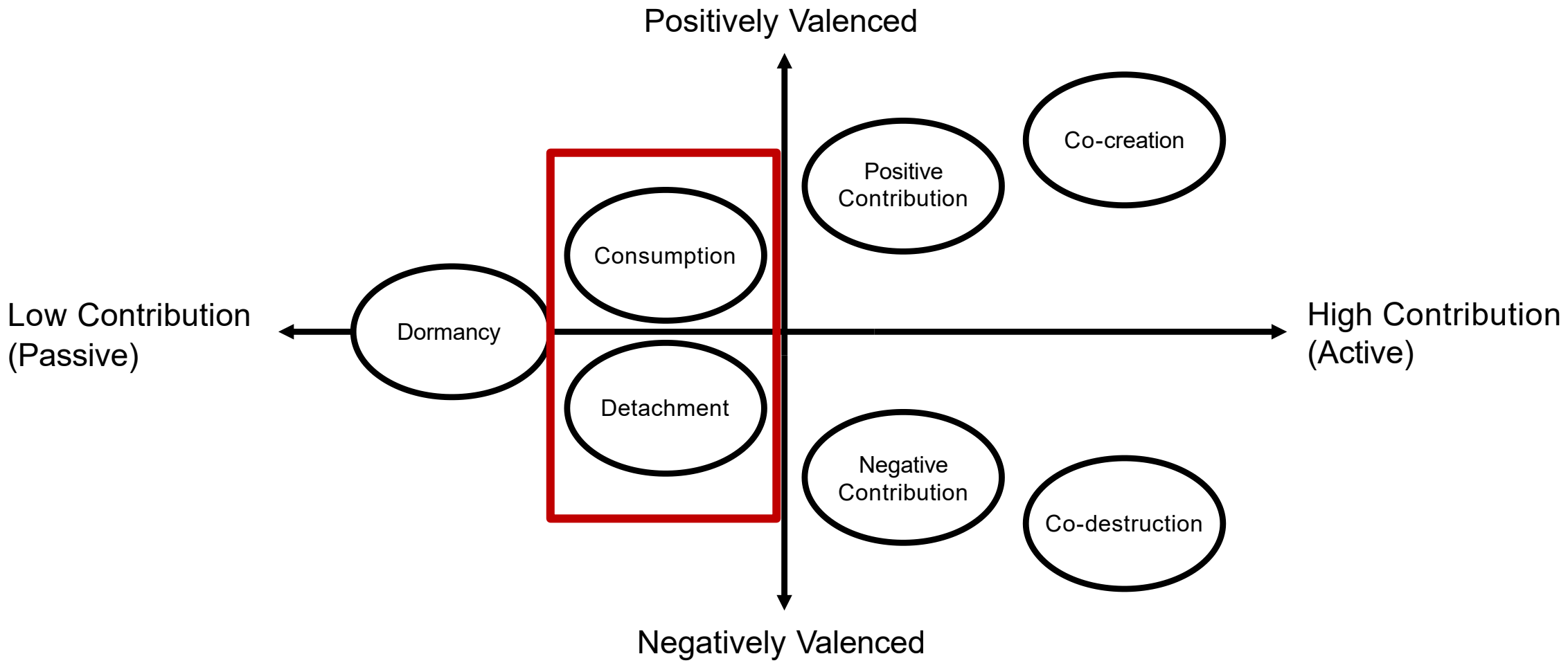
Example:

- Consumer does not respond to delivered brand-related content

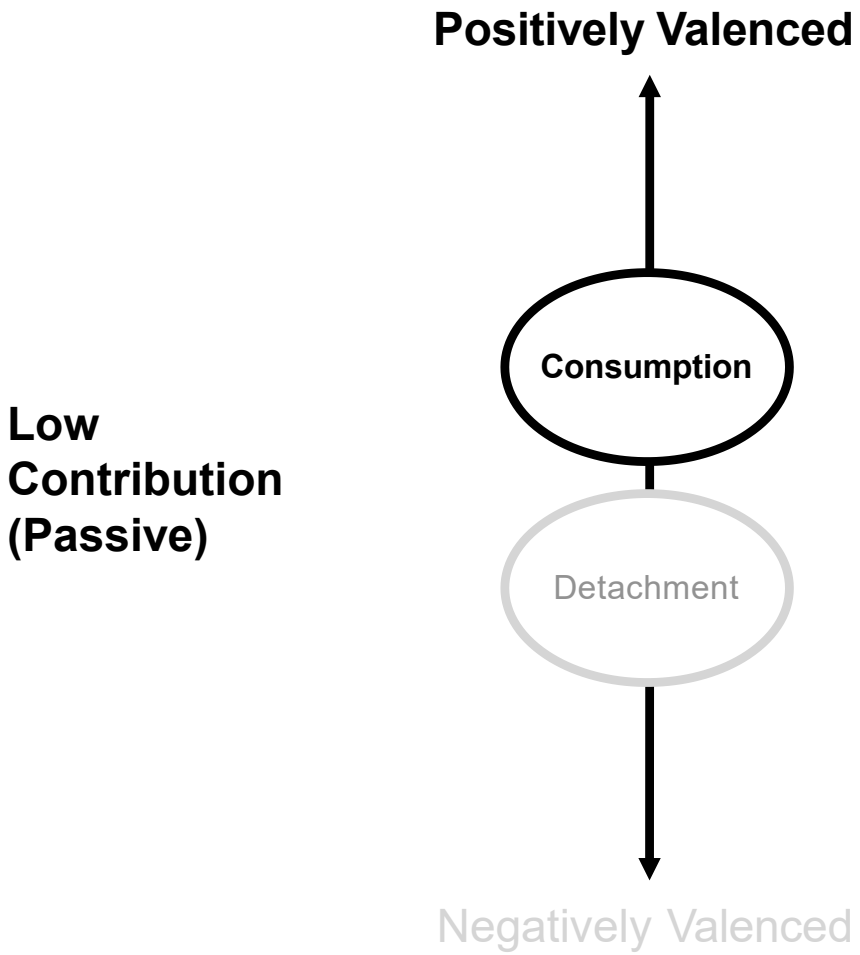
Source: Dolan (2016)

Social media engagement

A valence-based typology of how consumers engage.



Source: Dolan (2016)



Source: Dolan (2016)

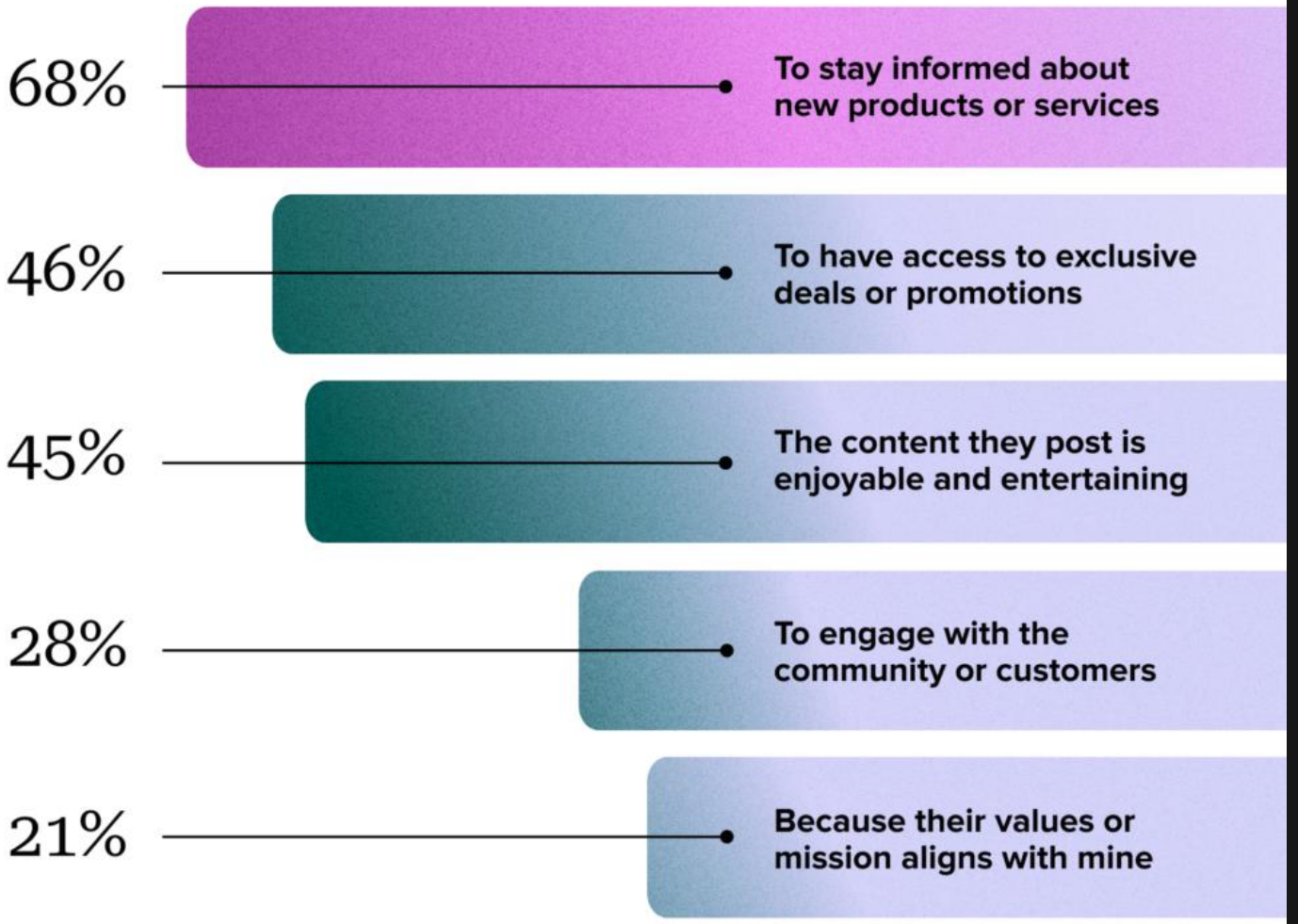
Consumption

The lowest level of ***positive*** SM engagement behaviour, where the user consumes brand-related content without reciprocation or contribution.

Examples:

- Following brands
- Reading brand posts
- Reading brand product reviews

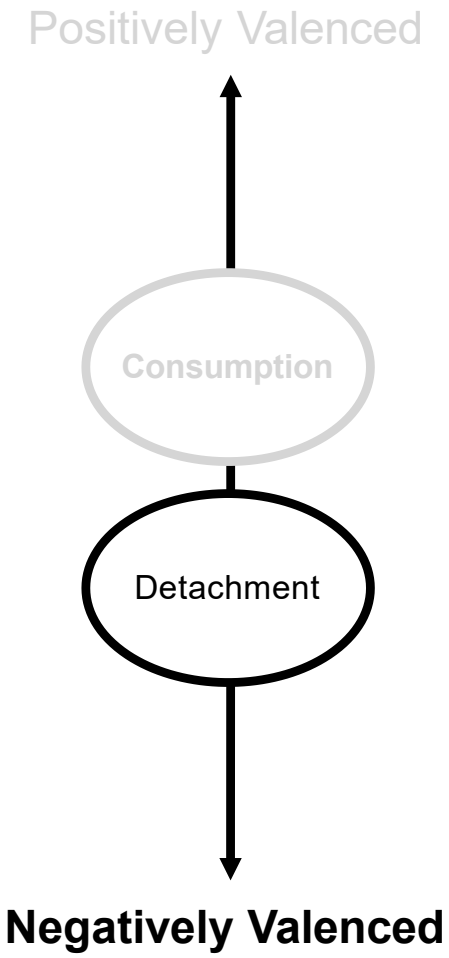
Consumers' primary reasons for following a brand on social



The Sprout Social Index™

sproutsocial

Source: Meier (2024) https://sproutsocial.com/insights/social-media-interaction/



Detachment

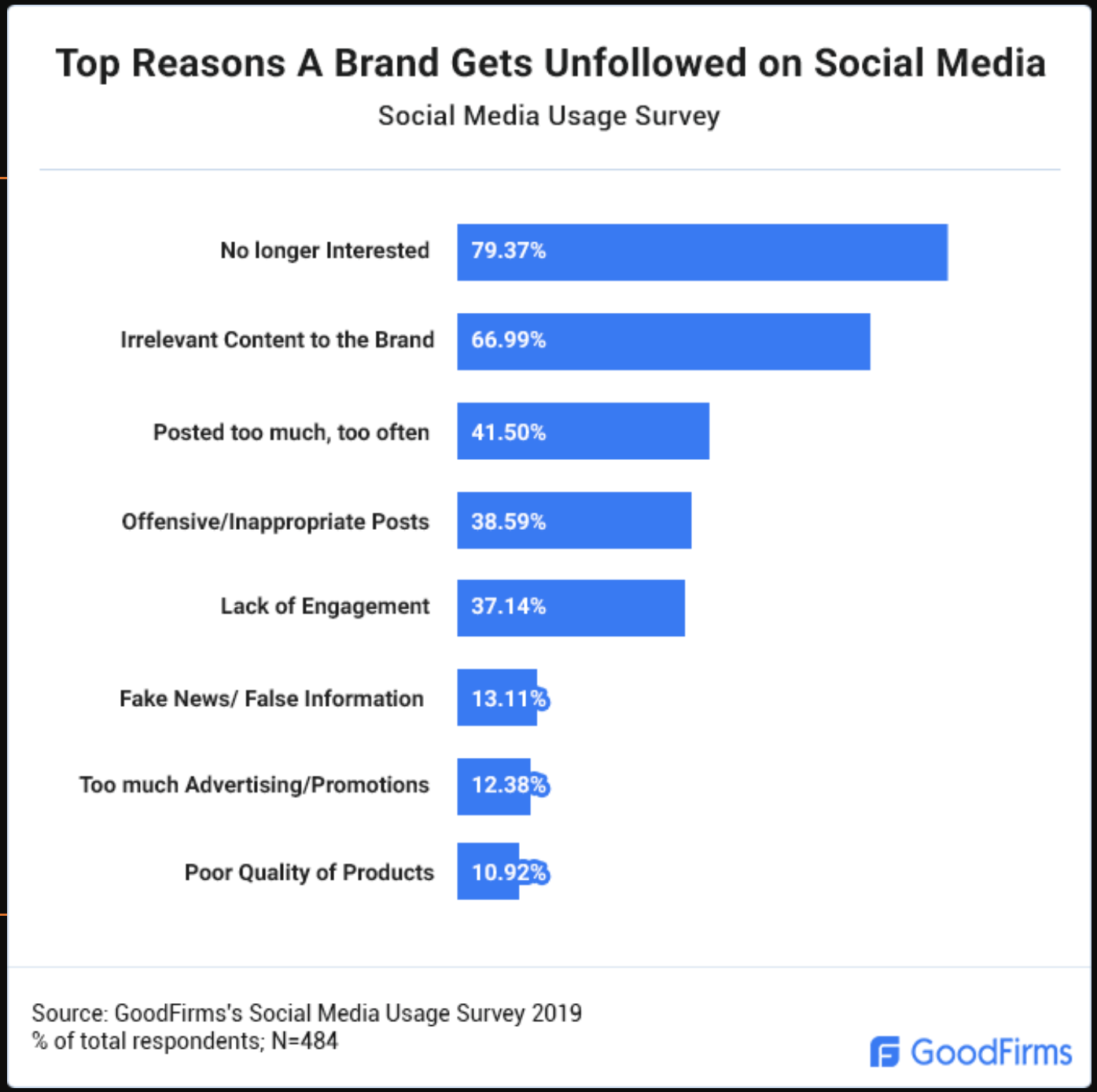
The lowest level of ***negative*** SM engagement behaviour, where the user temporarily or permanently cuts ties with the brand

Examples:

- Unfollowing a brand on social media
- Unsubscribing from a brand newsletter

Source: Dolan (2016)

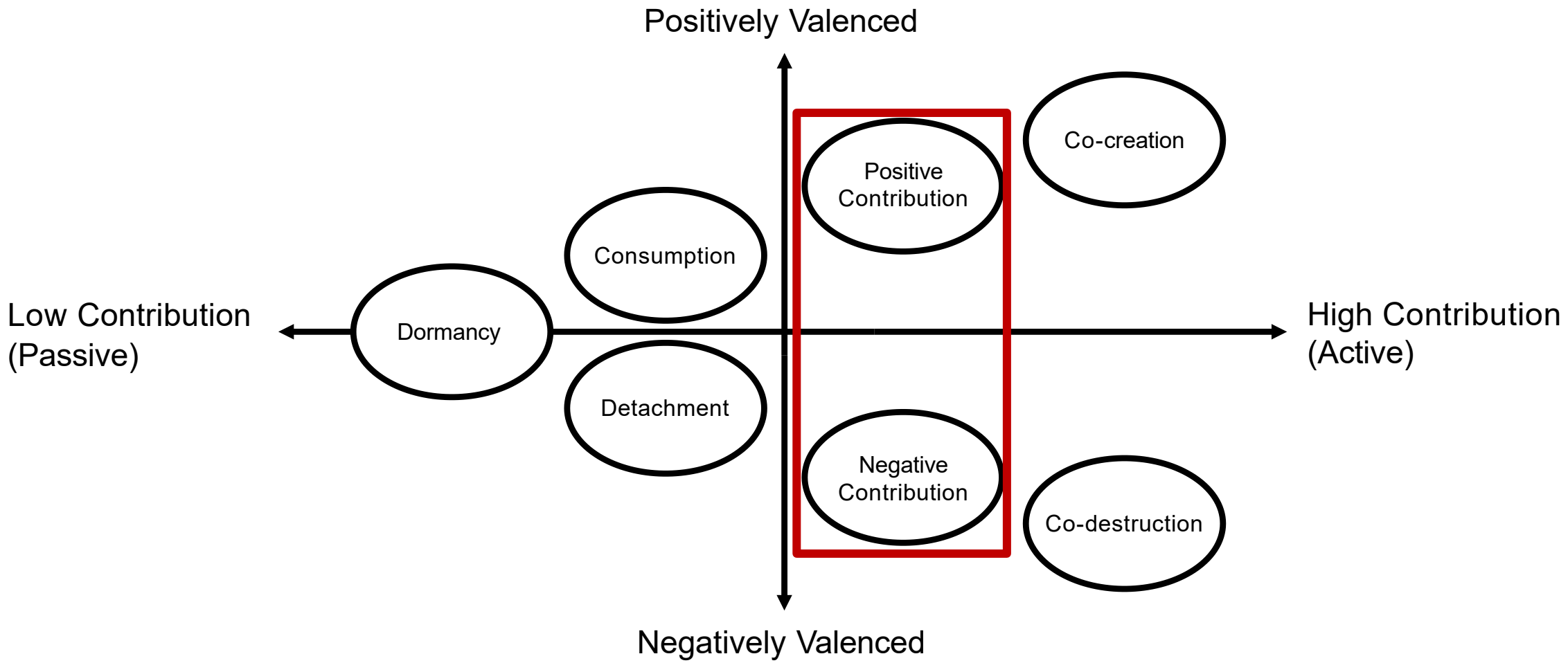
Why consumers disengage with brands' social media



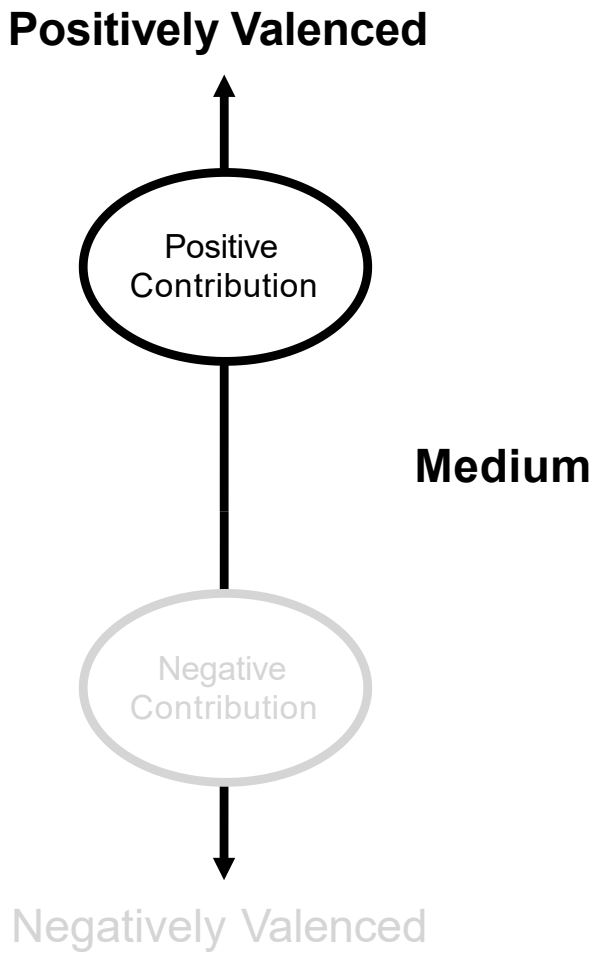
Source: Raymond (2024)

Social media engagement

A valence-based typology of how consumers engage.



Source: Dolan (2016)



Source: Dolan (2016)

Positive Contribution

A moderate level of positive SM engagement behaviour, where the user positively contributes to the brand's existing content

Examples:

- Liking & sharing brand content
- Leaving positive eWOM / ratings
- Contributing to brand forums / online communities

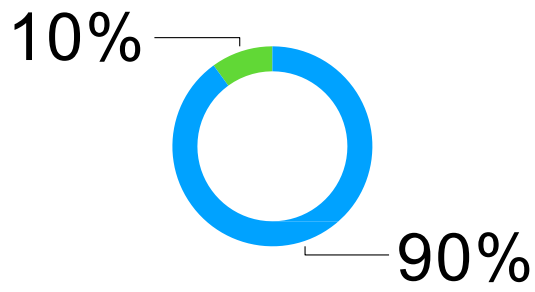
The Importance of eWOM

eWOM is any positive or negative statement made by potential, actual, or former customer about a product or company, which is made available to a multitude of people and institutions via the Internet (Hennig-Thurau et al., 2004)

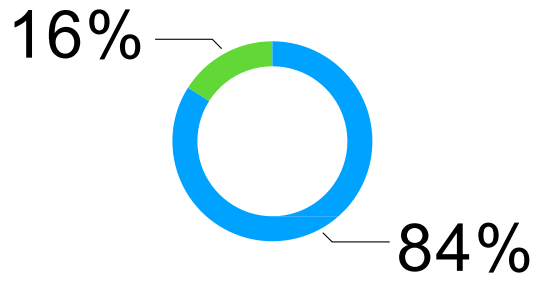




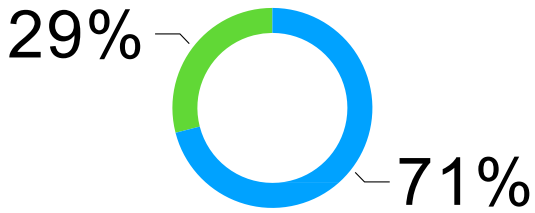
The Importance of eWOM



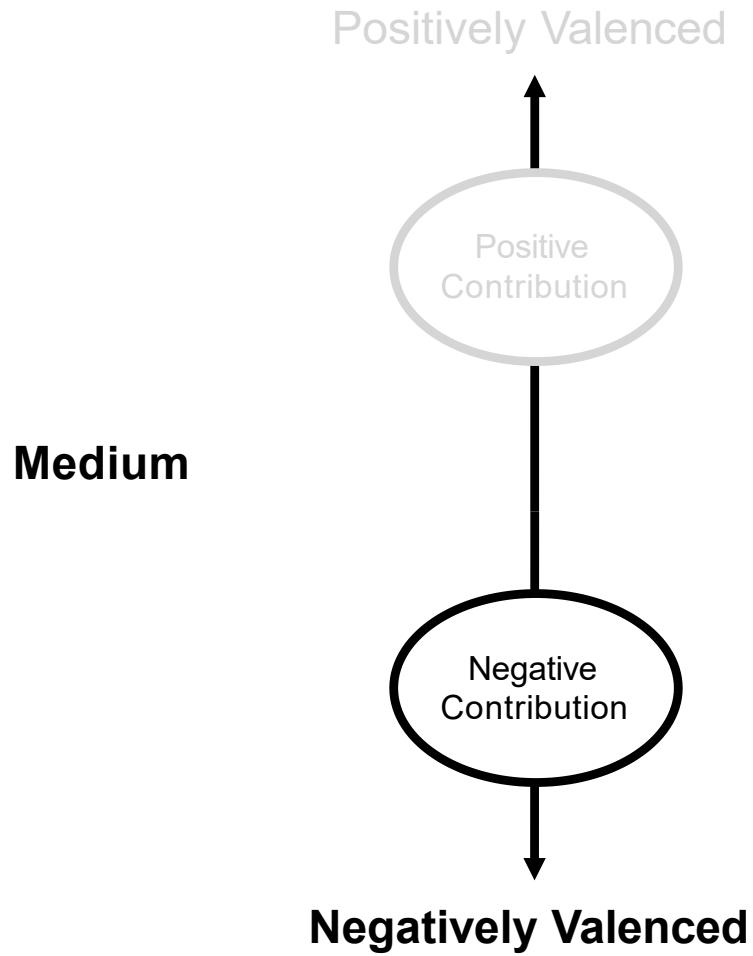
90% of consumers read online reviews before visiting a business



84% trust online reviews as much as personal recommendations



71% of consumers are more likely to make a purchase based on social media referrals



Source: Dolan (2016)

Negative Contribution

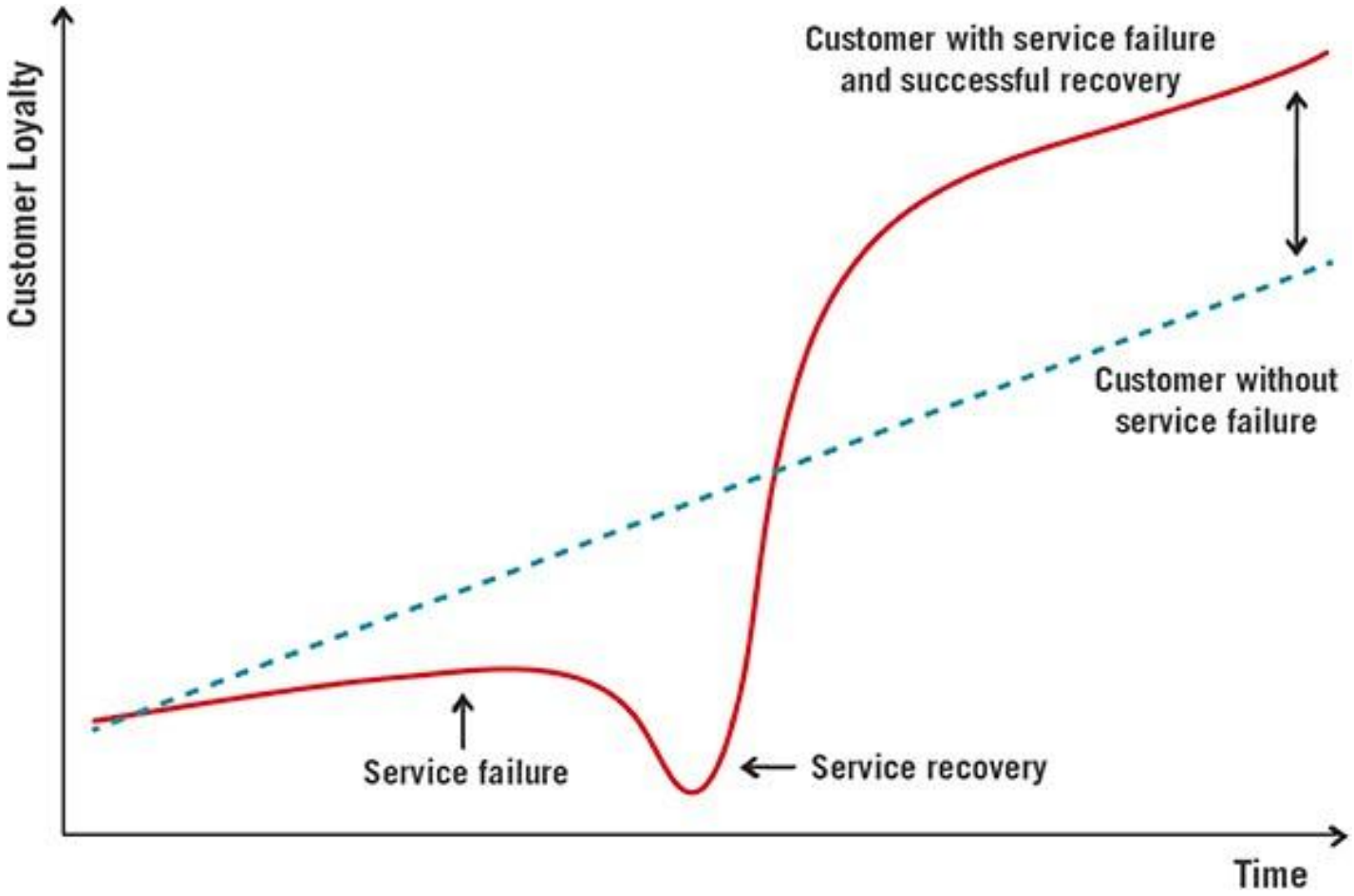
A moderate level of negative SM engagement behaviour, where the user negatively contributes to the brand's existing content

Examples:

- Negatively reviewing a brand online
- Conversing negatively on brand forums and online communities
- Trolling on online forums

HOW YOU RESPOND TO CUSTOMER NEGATIVITY IS CRUCIAL IN RETAINING CUSTOMER LOYALTY

The Service Recovery Paradox (SRP)



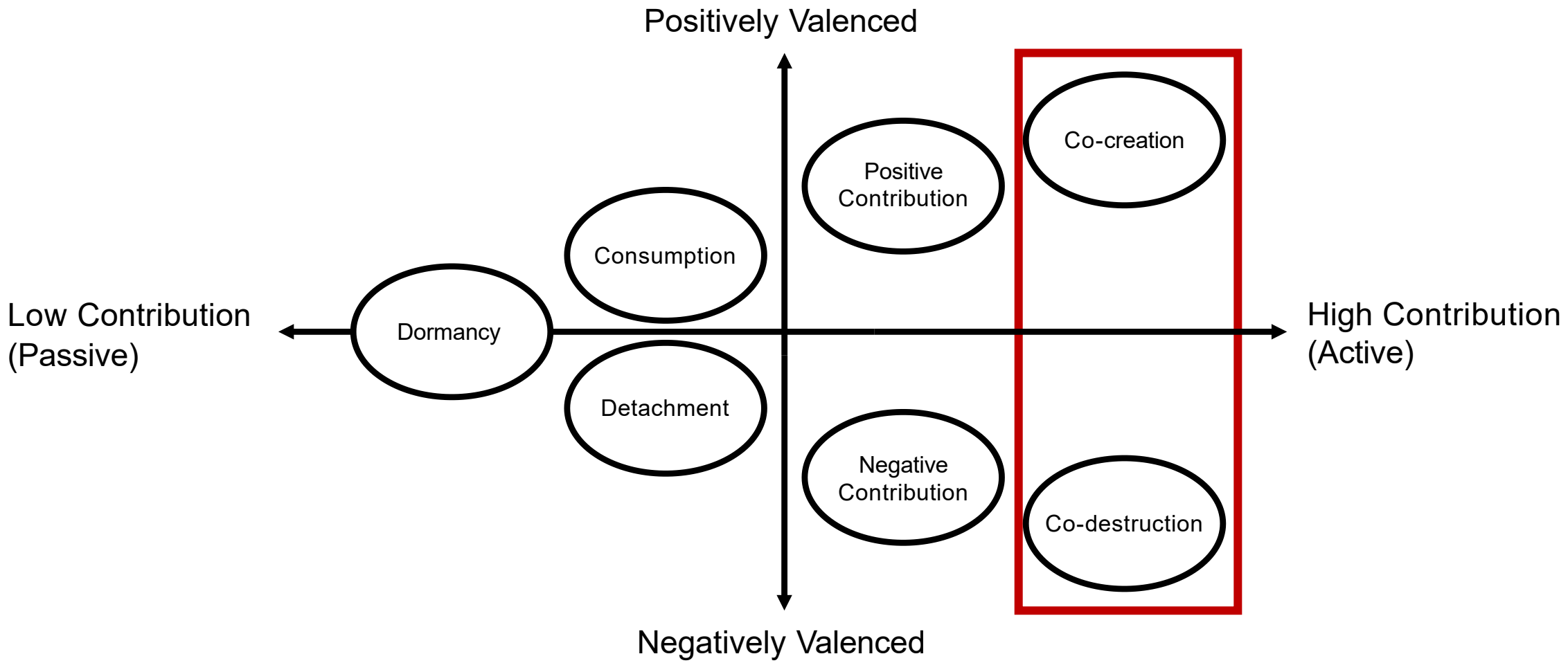
The Paradox:

Post-failure satisfaction exceeds pre-failure satisfaction following an effective service recovery.

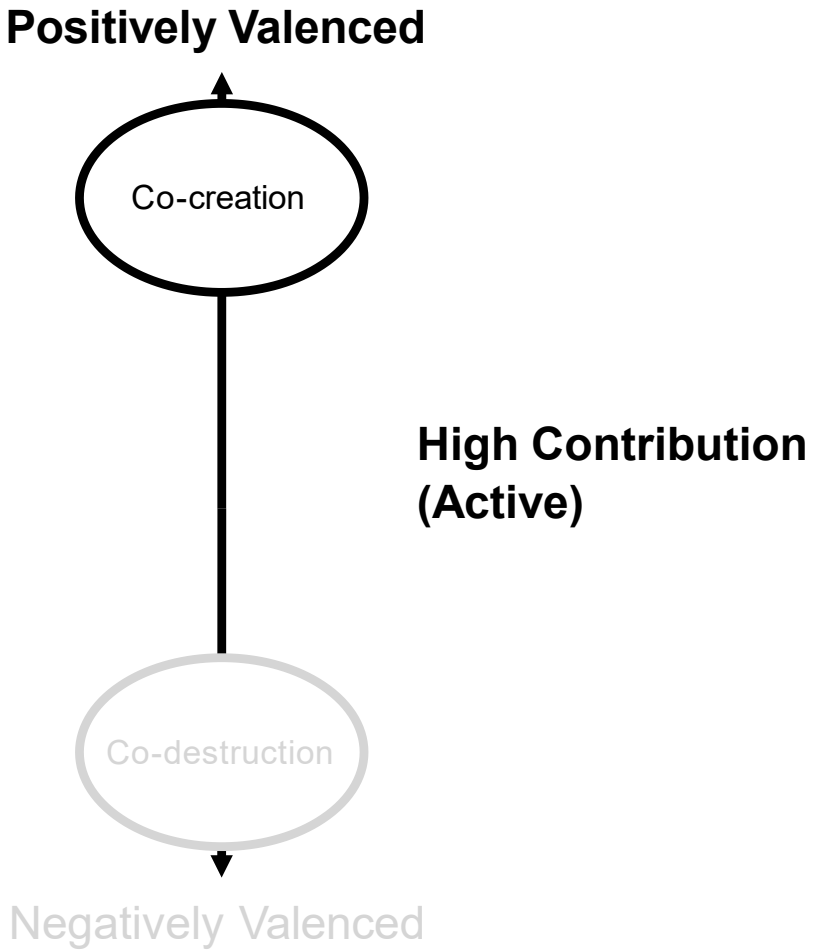
- The brand cares
- The brand is empathetic
- The brand is trustworthy
- **Increased loyalty**

Social media engagement

A valence-based typology of how consumers engage.



Source: Dolan (2016)



Source: Dolan (2016)

Co-creation

The highest form of ***positive*** SM engagement behaviour, where the user initiates unprompted and significant positive contributions to the brand.

Examples:

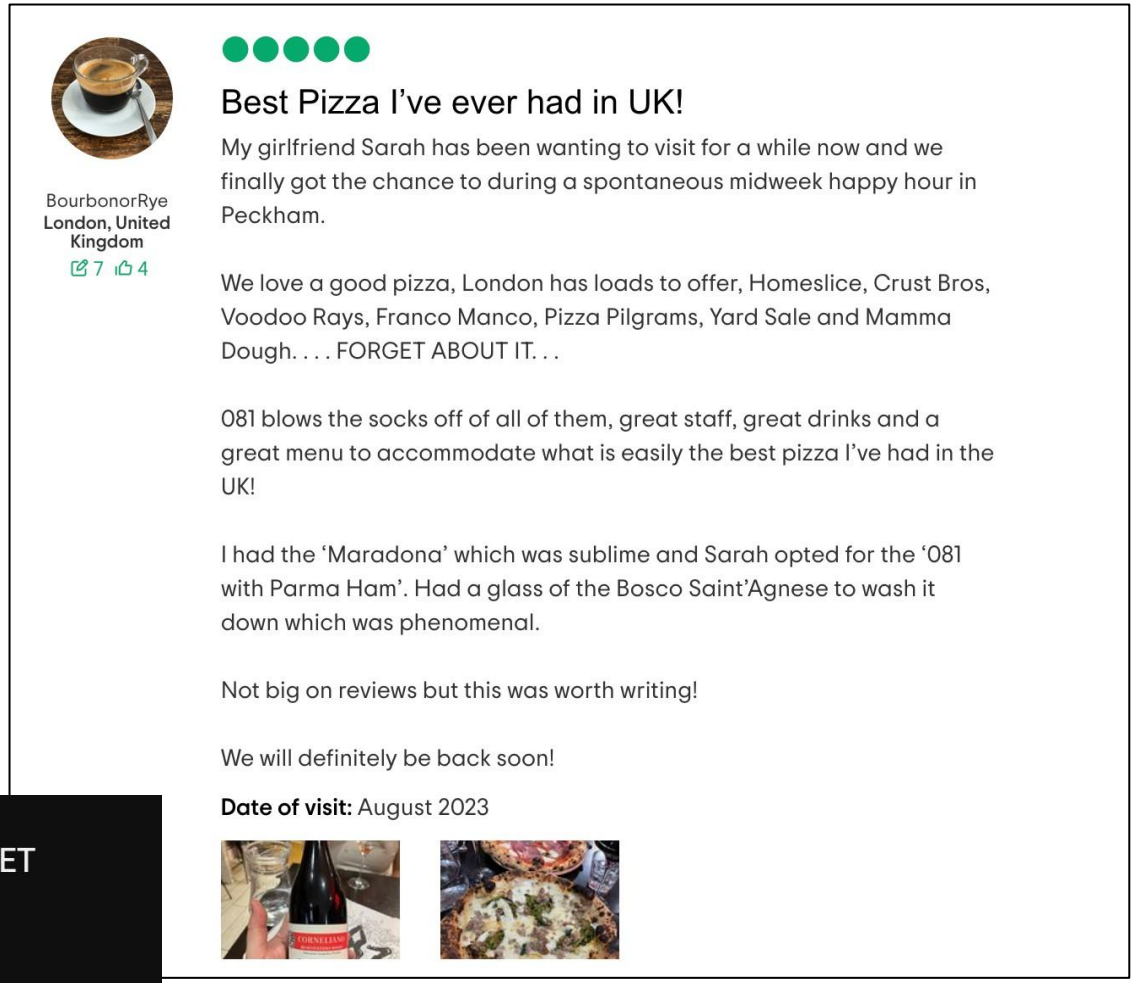
- Creating and sharing positive review videos about the brand.
- Uploading or sharing brand-related content on their personal channels

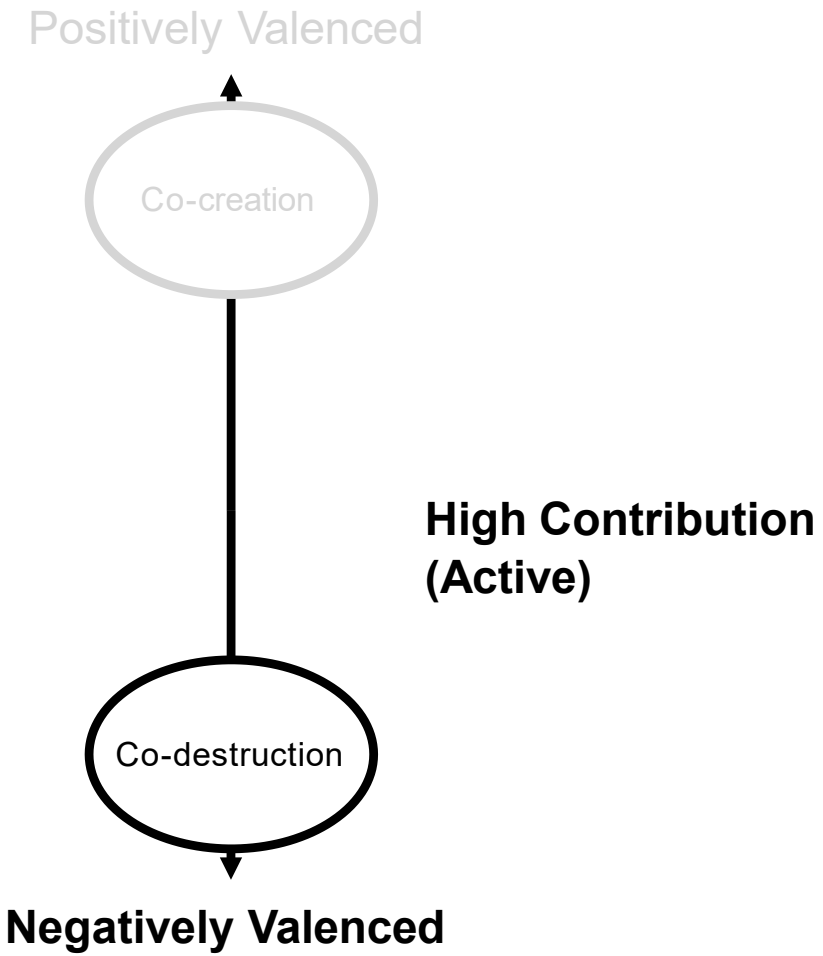
Co-Creation Examples

Free marketing by customers

Unpaid and unprompted







Co-destruction

The highest form of ***negative*** SM engagement behaviour, where the user attempts to enact revenge / sabotage on the brand.

Examples:

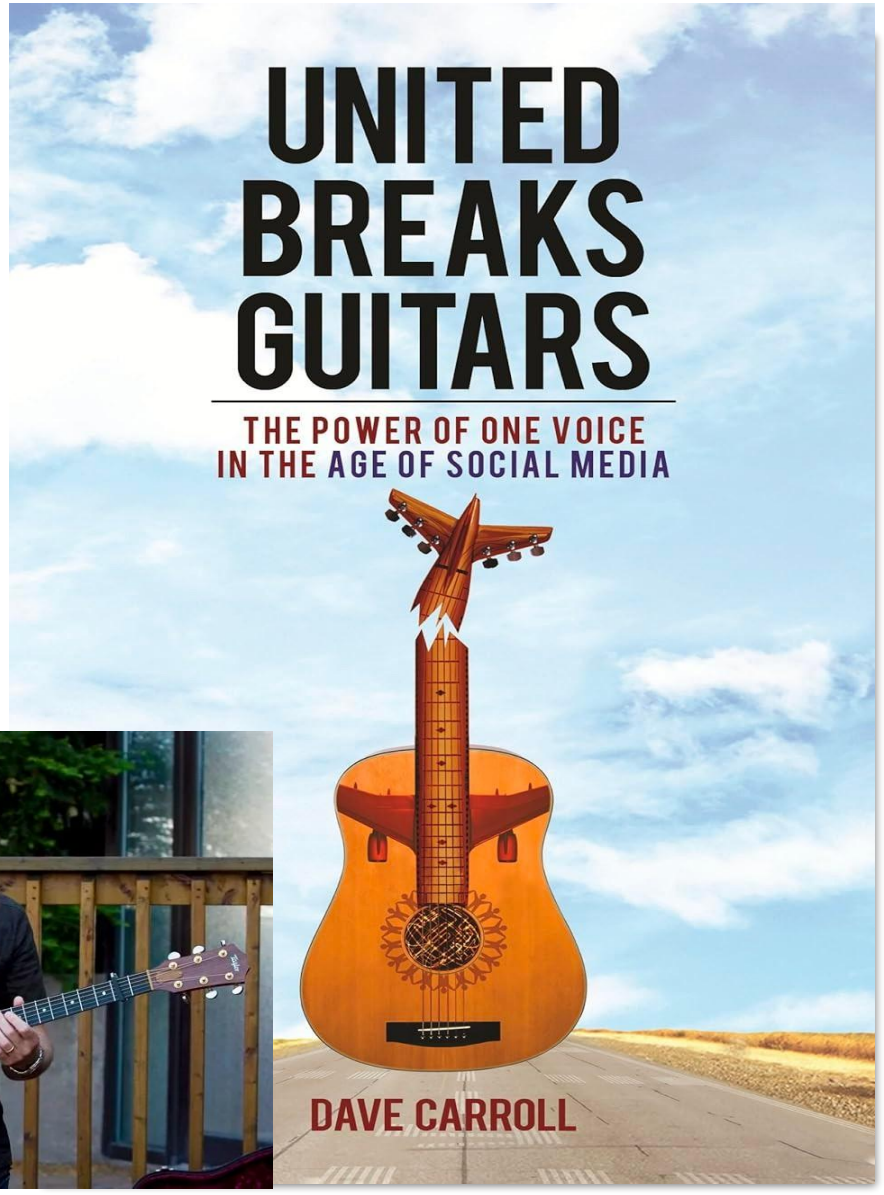
- Creating hate videos about the brand
- Bombarding the brand with fake negative reviews
- Attempting to alienate / turn existing customers away from the brand

Source: Dolan (2016)

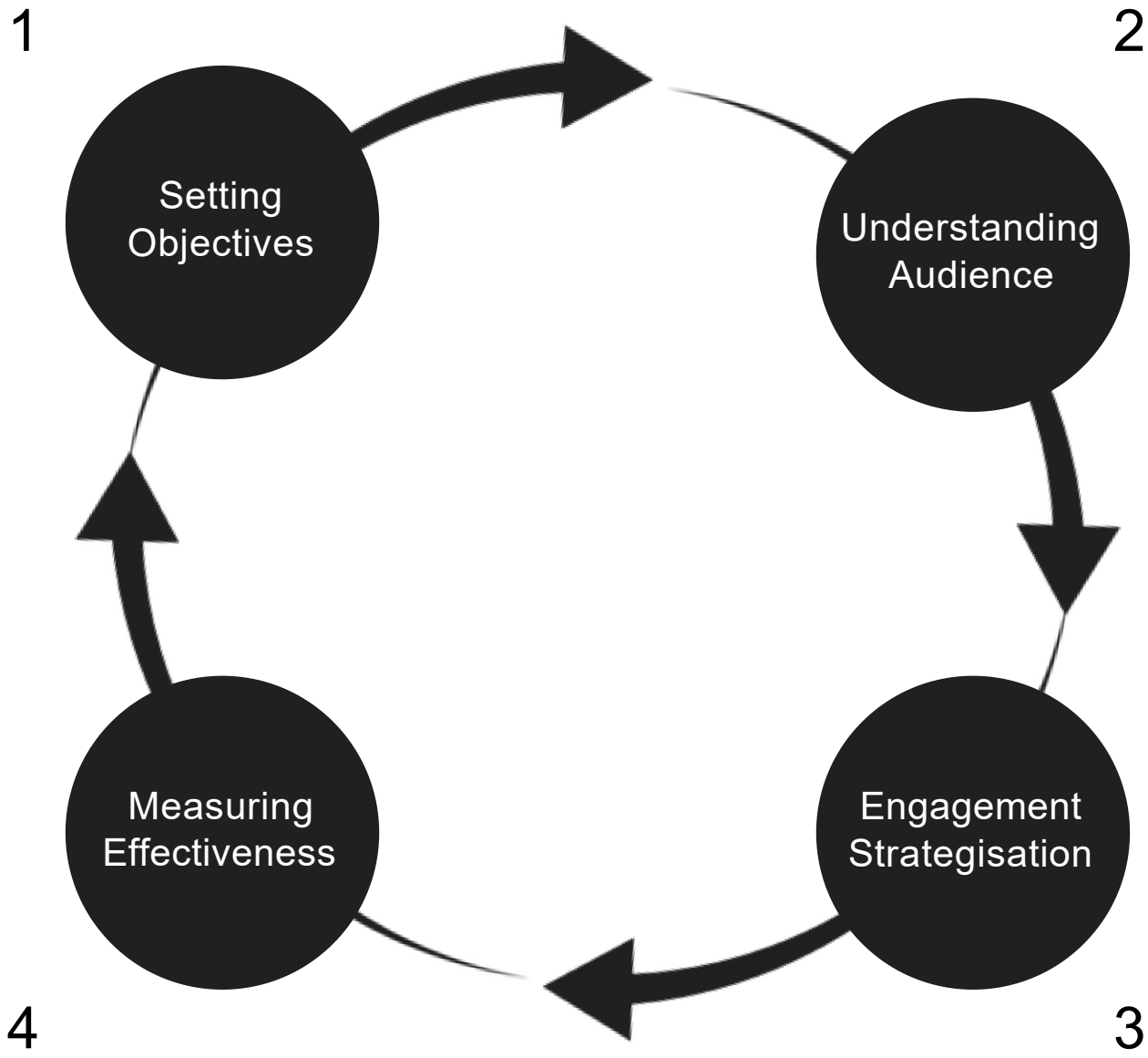
Co-destruction Exemplified: The Case of United Airlines

- In 2008, Canadian musician Dave Carrol had his $3500 guitar broken by United Airlines.
- The airline refused to compensate him.
- Dave posts a song titled “United Breaks Guitars” to YouTube.
- The video gains millions of views in a short time-span.
- Within 4 weeks of the video being posted, the company stock dropped 10% (a loss of over ~$180,000,000).



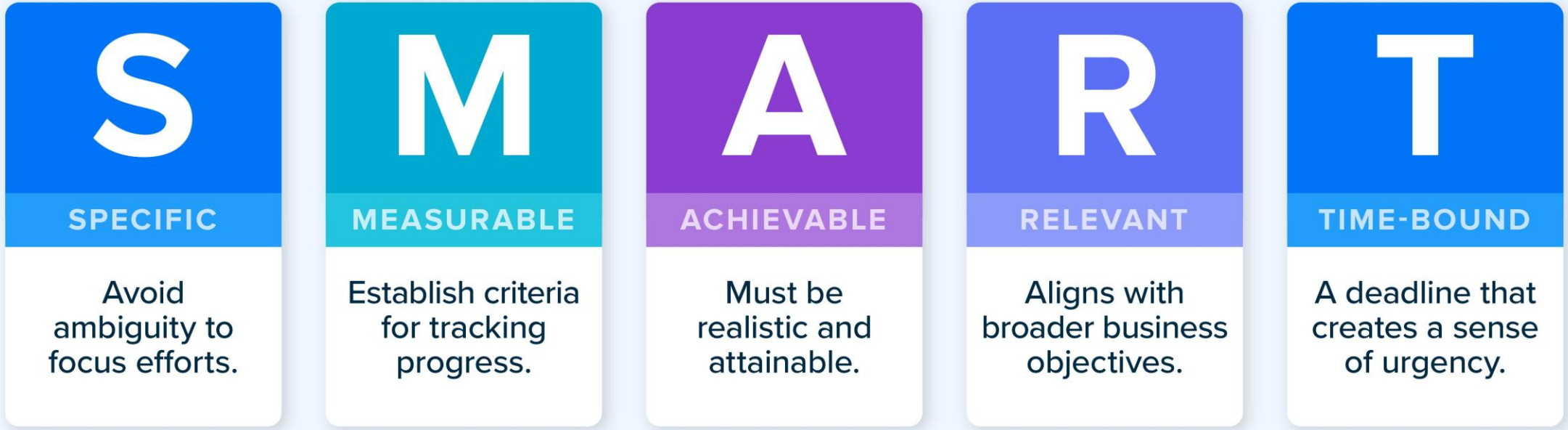


Driving Engagement: Strategies & Considerations


1
Setting Objectives
2
Understanding Audience
3
Engagement Strategisation
4
Measuring Effectiveness

Step 1. Setting Your Objectives

SMART Objectives Setting



Source: Agency Analytics (2023)

Engagement Focused

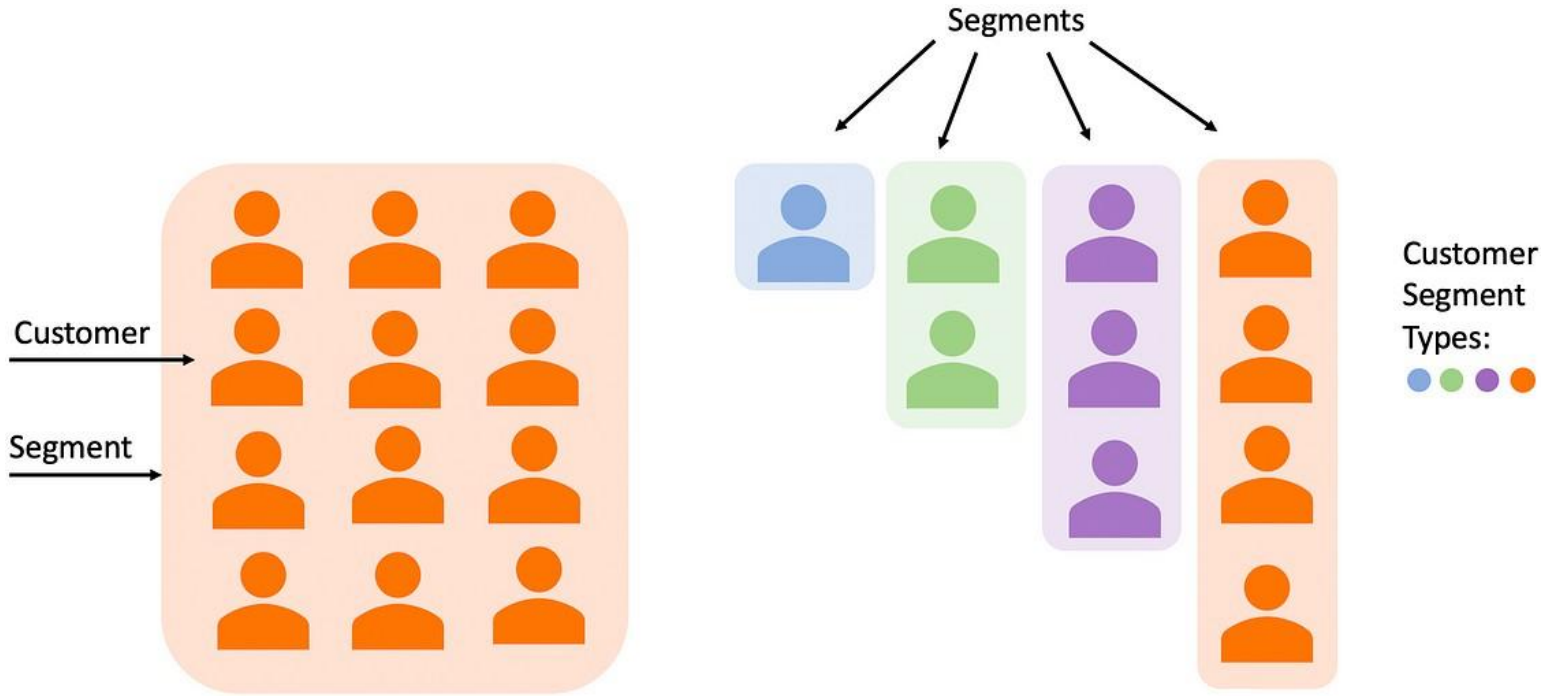


SPECIFIC	MEASURABLE	ACHIEVABLE	RELEVANT	TIME-BOUND
Increase overall social media engagement by 10% within the next 3 months	Using analytics we can track engagement (e.g., likes, comments, shares)	Yes, 10% is a fair level of engagement growth in the allotted timeframe	Yes, increasing engagement is an important facet of brand success	Yes, the timeframe is limited to 3-months before re-evaluating goals

Step 2. Understanding Your Audience

Audience Segmentation

The process of dividing a market into smaller, identifiable and distinct groups or segments, each with common characteristics and needs and responds similarly to marketing actions (Baines et al., 2013)



Able to deliver more relevant and tailored content

Improved customer experiences

Increased engagement

Segmentation - Example Characteristics

Demographics

Age

Gender

Salary

Family Status

Geographics

Location

City

Country

Timezone

Behaviours

Purchase history

Preferences

Response to incentives

Psychological

Personality Traits

Interests

Lifestyle

Values

Step 3. Engagement Strategies & Considerations

How to increase CBE on social media

Create interactive and relevant content

Engage in conversations with your audience

Use visual content

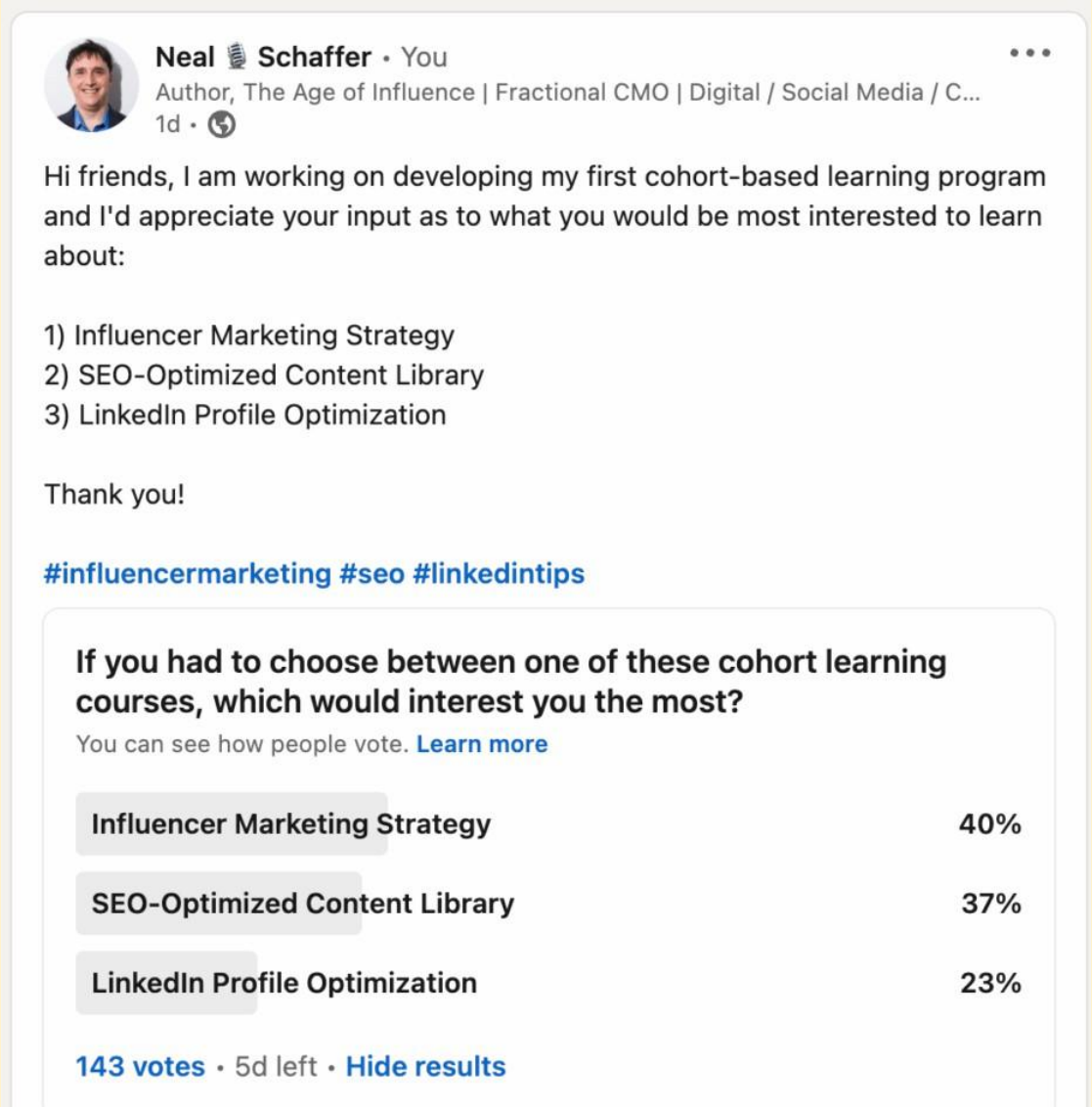
Use influencer marketing

How to increase CBE on social media

Create interactive and relevant content

- Polls
- Competitions: Contests and giveaways
- Quizzes
- Relatable content

Host polls/feedback events



Identify customer sentiment

Identify audience segments

Beneficial for general market research

Beneficial for customer experience

Contests & Giveaways

To Increase Engagement

Like / Share / Comment

User-generated content





Contests & Giveaways

To Increase Followers

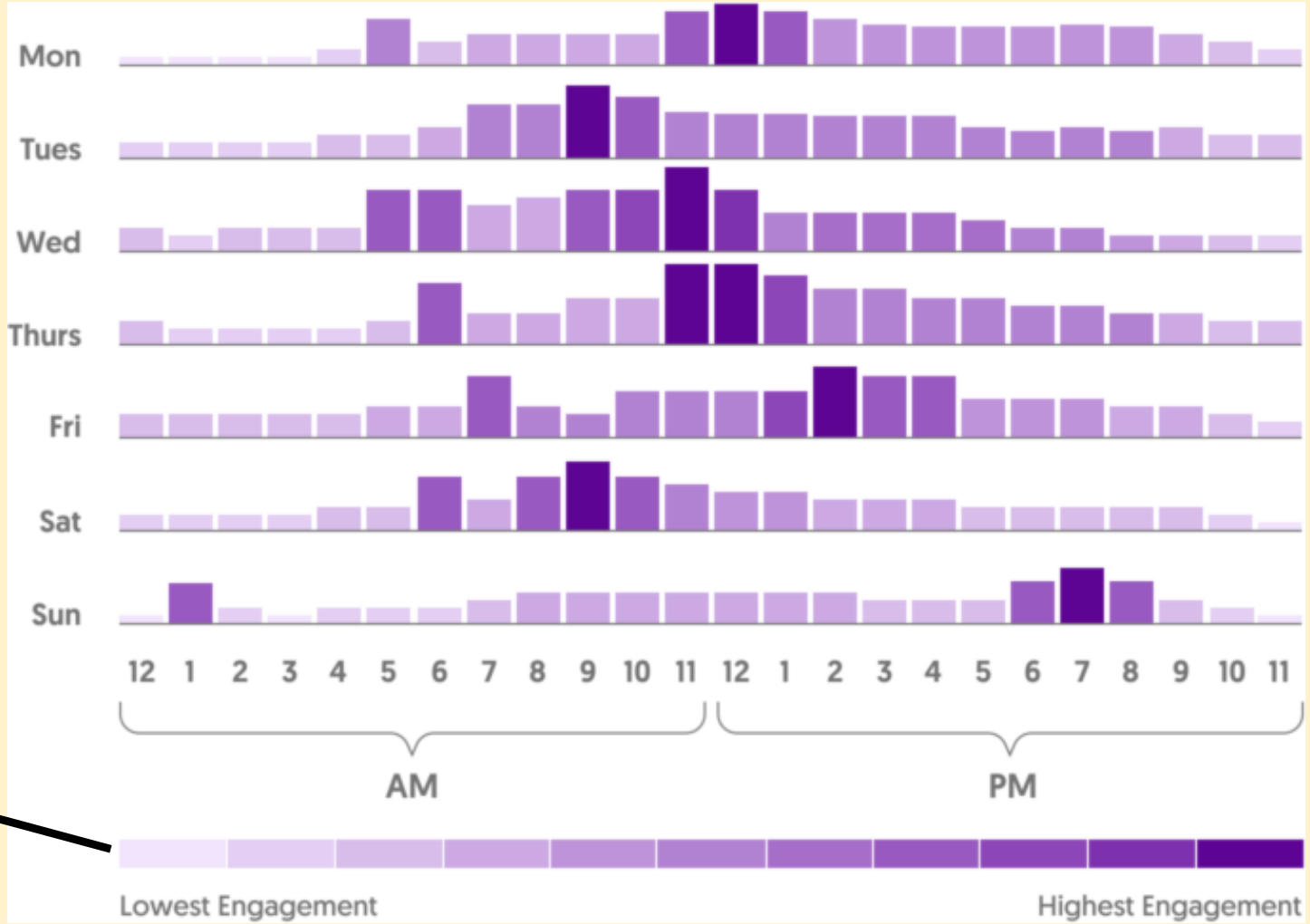
Tag a friend contest

Follow for a chance to win

Recurring contests



Consider Timing



Worst times

Best times

How to increase CBE on social media

Create interactive and relevant content

Engage in conversations with your audience

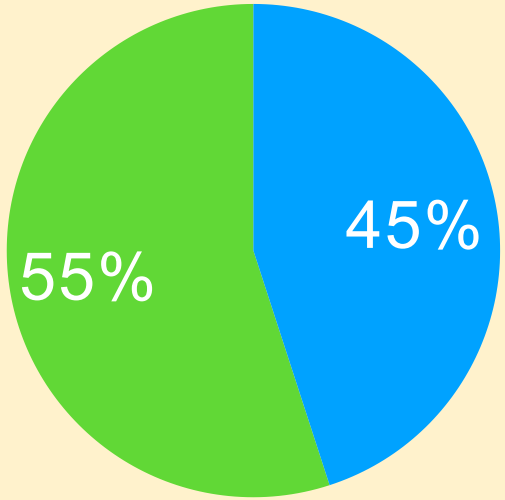
- Respond to your audience
- Live videos/streaming (consider cross-cultural differences)
- Ask them questions

Respond to Your Audience

Don’t ‘post and ghost’

When people comment on your video, interact with them.

Handle the negative comments effectively!



Nearly half of people (45%) say they would view a brand more positively if it responded to negative comments on social media.

How to increase CBE on social media

Create interactive and relevant content

Engage in conversations with your audience

Use visual content

- Short videos
- Visually appealing posts

Use influencer marketing

NEVER PAY FOR FAKE ENGAGEMENT

Fake likes, comments, or followers will only hurt your brand.

WHY?

Consider Platform Motivations

Users take to a variety of different social media platforms for different motivations.

Brands should follow conventions specific to each platform, as well as basic ‘netiquette’ principles.



Less Formal

More Hedonic

More Formal

More Utilitarian

Social Media Engagement Considerations

Considerations	Ask yourself…
Objective Matching	Does the strategy align with my objective(s)?
Channel Selection	Is the channel / content I am disseminating information on appropriate?
Quality of Content	Is the content delivered interesting and relevant to my brand's target audience?
Value offered	What benefits do customers gain from engaging with this content?
Ability to Engagement	Is there a clear way for viewers to engage with the content?
Planning & Scheduling	How frequently am I going to release similar content? Is this a one off campaign?
Incentivise	Should I include some sort of incentive for those who interact?
Metrics & KPIs	How will I measure effectiveness?

Step 4. Measure Effectiveness & Refining Processes

Social Media Metrics by Objective

Objective	Metrics to Consider
Increasing Engagement	Number of Likes / average likes per last X posts Number of Shares / average Number of Comments Brand mentions
Audience Data Growth	Follows per month / number of new followers Average audience reach per post (monthly or weekly) Device information
Brand Visibility	Number of impressions Total reach

Social Media Metrics by Objective

Objective	Metrics to Consider
Driving Traffic to Website	Click Through Rate (CTR) Conversion Rate Monthly Website Traffic
Increasing Sales / Conversions	Conversion Rate Return on Investment Sales Revenue Total Profit
Improving Customer Satisfaction	Customer feedback scores Average response time Resolution rate

Learning Outcomes - Recap

Now, you should be familiar with the following concepts:

- Consumer brand engagement
- Social media and its importance in driving engagement
- Engagement behaviours on social media
- Strategies to drive engagement

Seminar 4:

Engagement & Social Media

Next week's lecture…

Content marketing & Influencer marketing